

ENGLISH FOR OFFICE COORDINATION AND ADMINISTRATIVE SUPPORT

Office & Administration English

Clear arrangements. Reliable
follow-through.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For office assistants, reception staff, executive support teams, and administrators coordinating people, records, supplies, and schedules.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight everyday office situations demand precise English: cross-office scheduling, call messages, meeting actions, document corrections, delivery queries, visitor reception, travel comparisons, and deadline negotiations.

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Correct version, missing permission | Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

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Two Jordans, one visitor reference | Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

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A higher fare with a conditional refund | Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

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Make the arrangement explicit.

Administrative work connects people who hold different pieces of information. A useful message identifies the relevant person or record, separates a request from a promise, and makes the next action easy to understand.

Name the reference

A first name, clock time, or filename may not identify the intended person, moment, or document. Confirm the distinguishing detail before sending an invitation, directing a visitor, or circulating a correction.

"Do you mean 3:00 in your office, which is noon in the other office on this date?"

Keep requests and commitments distinct

A caller can request a deadline without the recipient agreeing to it. A manager can request an extra task without creating extra time. Preserve the request and ask for the missing confirmation or priority decision.

"Lena requests a callback before 4:00; availability has not been confirmed."

Separate preparation from approval

Obtaining quotations is not buying a printer. Comparing fares is not booking travel. A useful action record names the owner, deliverable, and due date without quietly adding spending authority.

"Sam will obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase is approved."

Correct the message without expanding authority

Replace outdated information clearly and identify the current source. An access problem should go to the document owner rather than prompting an unauthorized wider share. Courteous reception likewise preserves the actual visitor arrangements.

"Use approved version 3. I will ask the owner to resolve your viewing access."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All organizations, records, prices, schedules, and policies are fictional. Use actual workplace approval, security, privacy, purchasing, and records procedures. The time equivalence is supplied for the fictional meeting date, not a permanent conversion rule. Travel conditions belong only to the quoted options. This book teaches communication, not financial or legal advice, and does not authorize purchases, access changes, payments, or visitor entry.

Three o'clock in whose office?

A Read the situation

Clarify a missing time reference and read back two equivalent local times before issuing a meeting invitation.

Colleague Maya asks assistant Arun to arrange a 3:00 meeting with another office. For the fictional meeting date, 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time, but the request does not identify whose clock Maya means. Arun must confirm the intended office reference before sending invitations. No meeting duration, location, or recurrence has been specified.

PEOPLE / Maya: Colleague | Arun: Administrative assistant

A SMALL CLARIFICATION PREVENTS A LARGE SCHEDULING ERROR

A free calendar does not remove ambiguity in a spoken request. Ask whose local time is intended without suggesting that the colleague has made a foolish mistake. Once clarified, name both offices and their equivalent times in the readback.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from the initial request?

- A** Whether both calendars are open at the stated equivalent time
- C** The assistant's name

- B** Whether noon and 3:00 can be equivalent here
- D** Whose local time 3:00 refers to

2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

- A** Noon in Maya's office equals 3:00 elsewhere
- C** 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office

- B** The difference is permanently fixed for all dates
- D** Both offices show 3:00 simultaneously

3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

- A** Confirm the intended time reference
- C** Invent a meeting duration

- B** Assume the sender always means the recipient's time
- D** Treat an open calendar as acceptance

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

local time

Clock time at the specified location.

IN USE confirm local time

time zone

Region using a defined civil-time reference.

IN USE identify the time zone

time reference

Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning.

IN USE clarify the time reference

equivalent time

Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere.

IN USE read back the equivalent time

calendar availability

Time shown as open or occupied in a calendar.

IN USE check calendar availability

meeting request

Proposal to arrange a meeting with specified details.

IN USE clarify the meeting request

invitation

Message asking identified people to attend an event.

IN USE send the invitation

organizer

Person responsible for arranging the meeting.

IN USE identify the organizer

attendee

Person invited to or participating in a meeting.

IN USE confirm the attendee list

noon

Twelve o'clock in the middle of the day.

IN USE specify noon

date-specific

Valid for the particular date being discussed.

IN USE use a date-specific conversion

daylight saving time

Seasonal clock adjustment used in some locations; abbreviated DST.

IN USE check daylight saving time

Precision check

The supplied equivalence is 3:00 in Maya's office and noon in the other office on the fictional date. Do not put 3:00 on both local displays or assume the same difference applies on every date.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

Coordinated Universal Time

International time reference commonly abbreviated UTC.

IN USE identify Coordinated Universal Time

offset

Difference between one time reference and another.

IN USE verify the relevant offset

calendar entry

Event recorded in a scheduling system.

IN USE check the calendar entry

time display

Clock representation shown to a particular user.

IN USE compare the time displays

scheduling conflict

Overlap between incompatible calendar commitments.

IN USE resolve a scheduling conflict

free slot

Unoccupied period shown in a calendar.

IN USE identify a free slot

tentative hold

Provisional reservation not yet a final agreement.

IN USE distinguish a tentative hold

acceptance

Response agreeing to the stated invitation.

IN USE confirm acceptance

duration

Length of time an event is intended to last.

IN USE request the meeting duration

recurrence

Pattern under which an event repeats.

IN USE confirm recurrence separately

location field

Part of an invitation identifying where the meeting occurs.

IN USE complete the location field

schedule readback

Restatement of the agreed scheduling details.

IN USE give a schedule readback

Precision check

An open calendar is not proof that an invitation has been accepted. The initial request also supplies no duration, location, or recurrence. Confirm the intended reference first and leave other missing invitation details unresolved until they are provided.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE REFERENCE

"Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?"

KEEP THE QUESTION NEUTRAL

"I want to make sure both offices receive the same meeting time."

SEPARATE AVAILABILITY FROM INTENT

"The calendars are open, but I still need your intended time."

READ BACK THE LOCATION

"You mean 3:00 in your office."

EXPLAIN THE EQUIVALENCE

"On this date, your 3:00 is their noon."

STATE AVAILABILITY

"Both calendars are open at that equivalent time."

AVOID DUPLICATE CLOCK LABELS

"The two offices should not both be labeled 3:00."

READ BACK THE OTHER CLOCK

"That will be noon in the other office."

Do you mean ... or ...?

Offers the two relevant interpretations without choosing for the speaker.

On this date

Prevents a supplied time relationship becoming a permanent rule.

Their noon

Names the second office's local display.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE DATE

"This conversion is for the meeting date we are discussing."

DISTINGUISH ACCEPTANCE

"An open slot is not an accepted invitation."

IDENTIFY MISSING DURATION

"How long should the meeting last?"

KEEP RECURRENCE SEPARATE

"We have not agreed a repeating schedule."

AVOID A PERMANENT RULE

"I will not assume the same offset for every date."

HOLD THE SEND

"I will confirm the reference before sending."

IDENTIFY MISSING LOCATION

"We still need the meeting location."

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"I have the intended office time and its equivalent clearly recorded."

Before sending

Places clarification ahead of an externally visible commitment.

Still need

Identifies a remaining detail without undoing what is known.

Should not both

Corrects duplicate local labels for the same meeting instant.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is best?

- A** An open calendar means the time is obvious
- B** I will send 3:00 to both offices
- C** Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?
- D** I assume every office uses your clock

2. Which entry preserves the clarified meeting without adding missing details?

- A** One meeting: Maya 3:00, other office noon; one hour confirmed
- B** One meeting: Maya's office 3:00, other office noon; duration pending
- C** One meeting: both offices 3:00 local time; duration pending
- D** One meeting: Maya noon, other office 3:00; duration pending

3. What does calendar availability establish?

- A** Every invitee has accepted
- B** The meeting lasts an hour
- C** Recurrence is weekly
- D** The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

4. Which detail must not be invented?

- A** The missing time reference
- B** The need to clarify before sending
- C** A one-hour meeting duration
- D** The supplied noon equivalent

Answers and explanations: [page 85](#).

Three o'clock in whose office?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

schedule readback / Acceptance / time reference / Recurrence / local time / calendar availability / equivalent time / date-specific / meeting request / invitation

- 01 **Maya:** Could you set up three o'clock with the other office? Both calendars look open, so I'd like to get it arranged.
- 02 **Arun:** Before I send anything, which ¹ _____ do you mean: three in your office or three in theirs?
- 03 **Maya:** Three here. I was looking at my own calendar and forgot that the other office would see a different time.
- 04 **Arun:** Thanks. On this date the ² _____ there is noon. I'll state both offices so we're referring to the same meeting.
- 05 **Maya:** Yes, three here and noon there. Please don't put three next to both office names in the message.
- 06 **Arun:** Agreed. There are two ³ _____ displays for one meeting, not two meetings at the same clock time.
- 07 **Maya:** Is that enough to send it? The free slots were what I checked before asking you.
- 08 **Arun:** The ⁴ _____ helps, but I still need the duration and location. Neither was in the request.
- 09 **Maya:** I'll send those separately. For now, can you keep the intended time without filling in an hour by default?
- 10 **Arun:** Yes. I'll retain the ⁵ _____ as three here and noon there on this date, with those other details outstanding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Maya:** We may need another meeting with them later. Can I just use the same three-hour difference every time?
- 12 **Arun:** I'd check each date. This is a ⁶ _____ equivalence; it isn't a standing rule for future meetings.
- 13 **Maya:** Understood. Also, seeing a free slot doesn't mean their colleagues have agreed to attend, does it?
- 14 **Arun:** No. ⁷ _____ is a separate response. We shouldn't say they've agreed just because their calendars appear open.
- 15 **Maya:** Please keep the eventual message as a request, then. I don't want it to sound as though attendance is already settled.
- 16 **Arun:** The ⁸ _____ will ask them to attend at the clarified time, and we'll track their responses separately.
- 17 **Maya:** Let me check: three in my office, noon in theirs, on the date we're discussing. Nothing sent yet.
- 18 **Arun:** That's the ⁹ _____. I'll keep it while we obtain the duration and location rather than assume either.
- 19 **Maya:** I'll send those next. And this is only one meeting for now, not a weekly series.
- 20 **Arun:** Understood. ¹⁰ _____ hasn't been authorized. I'll wait for the remaining details before sending the single meeting request.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. time reference | 2. equivalent time | 3. local time | 4. calendar availability | 5. meeting request | 6. date-specific | 7. Acceptance | 8. invitation | 9. schedule readback | 10. Recurrence

Read back one meeting in two local times

F Say it

Complete the scheduling clarification without adding a duration or treating availability as acceptance.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

time / sending / open / noon

Assistant: "Whose local ¹ _____ do you mean?"

Colleague: "Three in my office equals ² _____ at the other office."

Assistant: "Both calendars are ³ _____ at that time."

Colleague: "Confirm the remaining details before ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. time | 2. noon | 3. open | 4. sending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the scheduling dialogue using the word bank.
2. Read the two office times aloud as one meeting: 3:00 here, noon there, on the supplied date. Then read the unresolved duration and location.
3. Complete the transfer, check the explained key, and repeat the corrected scheduling readback.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

A Read the situation

Route a caller by purpose, capture the reference and preferred reply route, and relay a requested deadline without guaranteeing it.

Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but team availability is unknown. Assistant Dev must confirm the delivery reference and preferred contact route, read back the message, and preserve the requested deadline as a request. The conversation supplies no payment problem or confirmed callback commitment.

PEOPLE / Lena: Caller | Dev: Office assistant

ROUTE BY THE PURPOSE, NOT BY THE FIRST FAMILIAR WORD

A delivery reference can sound like an invoice reference over the phone. Confirm the reason for the call before selecting a team. Taking a message is useful work, but it does not give the assistant control over the recipient's availability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which team does Lena need?

A Facilities

C Payroll

B Finance

D An unidentified invoice department

2. What is the facilities extension?

A 241

C D18

B 412

D 214

3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

A A guaranteed response time

C A delivery time already agreed

B A confirmed payment deadline

D A requested callback deadline

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

call routing

Directing a telephone inquiry to the appropriate recipient.

IN USE confirm call routing

facilities team

Staff coordinating the relevant building or workplace services.

IN USE contact the facilities team

finance team

Staff handling the relevant financial records and processes.

IN USE distinguish the finance team

extension

Internal telephone number used within an organization.

IN USE confirm the extension

delivery reference

Identifier attached to a particular delivery.

IN USE capture the delivery reference

caller identity

Name and relevant identifying details of the person calling.

IN USE verify caller identity

purpose of call

Reason the caller needs contact.

IN USE clarify the purpose of call

message slip

Written record of a call for another person.

IN USE complete the message slip

callback request

Request for someone to return a telephone call.

IN USE relay a callback request

requested deadline

Time by which the caller would like a response.

IN USE preserve the requested deadline

preferred contact route

Communication method selected by the caller.

IN USE confirm the preferred contact route

contact details

Information needed to reach the intended person.

IN USE verify contact details

Precision check

The reference is delivery D18, and the team is facilities at extension 214. Do not turn the call into an invoice query for finance. A good message retains the name, purpose, reference, contact route, and requested deadline.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

transfer

Connection of an existing call to another line.

IN USE distinguish a transfer from a callback

voicemail

Recorded message left when a recipient is unavailable.

IN USE identify the voicemail option

recipient availability

Whether the intended person or team can respond.

IN USE check recipient availability

message readback

Spoken repetition of a message to confirm its accuracy.

IN USE give a message readback

reference correction

Amendment of a misheard identifier.

IN USE record a reference correction

department

Organizational team with a defined function.

IN USE identify the correct department

misdirected call

Call sent to a recipient who does not handle its purpose.

IN USE prevent a misdirected call

response commitment

Agreed promise to reply at a specified time or stage.

IN USE distinguish a response commitment

call log

Record of telephone contacts and their relevant details.

IN USE update the call log

recipient confirmation

Verification that the intended recipient has received or accepted the message.

IN USE obtain recipient confirmation

urgency

Stated need for prompt attention.

IN USE explain the urgency

handoff note

Message passed to another person for follow-up.

IN USE prepare an accurate handoff note

Precision check

Before 4:00 is Lena's requested response deadline, not a confirmed team commitment. Confirm the preferred route and relevant contact details without inventing a telephone number. A message being taken does not establish that the recipient can meet the request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE PURPOSE

"Is this about the delivery or an invoice?"

ASK FOR THE REFERENCE

"Could you confirm the delivery reference?"

NAME THE EXTENSION

"Facilities is on extension 214."

ASK FOR THE ROUTE

"How would you prefer the team to contact you?"

IDENTIFY THE TEAM

"You need facilities rather than finance."

READ BACK THE IDENTIFIER

"That is D18, D followed by eighteen."

CONFIRM THE CALLER

"I have your name as Lena Park."

VERIFY THE DETAILS

"May I check the contact details for that route?"

Rather than

Corrects the department without changing the caller's purpose.

D followed by eighteen

Makes a short reference easier to distinguish over the phone.

Would prefer

Elicits the caller's chosen communication route.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CAPTURE THE TIMING

"You are requesting a callback before 4:00."

AVOID AN INVENTED PROMISE

"I can relay the request, but I cannot guarantee that time."

KEEP THE PURPOSE INTACT

"This concerns delivery D18, not an invoice."

INVITE A CORRECTION

"Is any part of that message inaccurate?"

STATE THE LIMIT

"I cannot confirm the team's availability."

SEPARATE TRANSFER AND CALLBACK

"Taking a message is not the same as connecting the call."

READ BACK THE WHOLE MESSAGE

"Lena Park requests facilities to call about D18 before 4:00."

CLOSE HONESTLY

"I will pass on the requested deadline with the contact route."

Requesting

Marks the deadline as the caller's wish, not an accepted promise.

Cannot guarantee

Limits the assistant's commitment while preserving a useful action.

Any part ... inaccurate?

Invites a specific correction to the completed readback.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message is accurate?

- A** Finance guarantees payment of invoice D18 at 4:00
- B** Facilities has already returned the call
- C** Lena has approved a new delivery charge
- D** Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

2. Which response overpromises?

- A** Please confirm your preferred contact route
- B** They will definitely call before four
- C** I will relay your requested deadline
- D** Their availability is not confirmed

3. Which information still needs verification before the message is usable?

- A** The actual contact details for Lena's chosen reply route
- B** A new department because facilities cannot handle deliveries
- C** A payment amount for the D18 invoice
- D** A guaranteed four o'clock appointment with finance

4. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

- A** Delivery 214
- B** Invoice 412
- C** Extension 214
- D** Extension 241

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

response commitment / delivery reference / message readback / extension / handoff note / preferred contact route / callback request / requested deadline / caller identity / purpose of call

- 01 **Lena:** Hello, Lena Park here. I was sent to finance about D18, but I think I need facilities.
- 02 **Dev:** Let me check the ¹ _____ first. Are you calling about a delivery or an invoice? I want to make sure the message reaches the right team.
- 03 **Lena:** It's delivery D18, not an invoice. I'm trying to reach the facilities team.
- 04 **Dev:** Thank you. I have the ² _____ as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.
- 05 **Lena:** Could they call me before four? That's when I need the delivery question answered.
- 06 **Dev:** I will record a ³ _____ before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.
- 07 **Lena:** Please keep before four in the message, even if you can't confirm they'll meet it.
- 08 **Dev:** Certainly. The ⁴ _____ will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?
- 09 **Lena:** A telephone call, please. I'll confirm the contact number with you.
- 10 **Dev:** I will note the ⁵ _____ as telephone and verify the relevant details with you. I will not substitute email just because it is easier to forward.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Lena:** Use Lena Park, not just Lena. Another person here has called about a different delivery.
- 12 **Dev:** Yes. The ⁶ _____ is Lena Park. I will keep your name, delivery D18, and the contact details together so the handoff is not ambiguous.
- 13 **Lena:** Was the extension two-one-four? I wrote two-four-one and may have reversed the last digits.
- 14 **Dev:** It is ⁷ _____ 214, two-one-four. The delivery identifier remains D18. I will keep those two kinds of reference separate in the note.
- 15 **Lena:** Could you read the message back before we finish? I want to check the team and the delivery reference together.
- 16 **Dev:** Here is the ⁸ _____: Lena Park requests a telephone callback from facilities about delivery D18 before four. The contact details are to be verified, and team availability is not confirmed.
- 17 **Lena:** That's right. There isn't a finance approval or payment question to add.
- 18 **Dev:** Agreed. The ⁹ _____ will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.
- 19 **Lena:** Thank you. I understand you're passing on a request, not guaranteeing their response.
- 20 **Dev:** Exactly. A ¹⁰ _____ has not yet been established. I will relay the accurate request and keep the distinction clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. purpose of call | 2. delivery reference | 3. callback request | 4. requested deadline | 5. preferred contact route | 6. caller identity | 7. extension | 8. message readback | 9. handoff note | 10. response commitment

Pass on the caller's actual request

F Say it

Complete the message summary. Keep the department, reference, extension, and deadline status accurate.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

D18 / 214 / deadline / facilities

Assistant: "Lena needs the ¹ _____ team."

Caller: "The delivery reference is ² _____."

Assistant: "The team extension is ³ _____."

Caller: "Before 4:00 is my requested ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. facilities | 2. D18 | 3. 214 | 4. deadline

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the call-message dialogue.
2. Read back Lena Park, delivery D18, facilities extension 214, telephone preference, and requested before-four deadline. Keep request separate from guarantee.
3. Complete the transfer and check each identifier against the key before rereading the whole message.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two quotes, not permission to buy

A Read the situation

03

Use the final minutes of a meeting to confirm an action owner, deliverable, deadline, and deferred agenda item.

Ten minutes remain in an office meeting. The two outstanding agenda items are printer replacement and visitor signage. Chair Farah prioritizes the printer decision. Assistant Sam can obtain two quotations by Thursday, but nobody has approved a purchase. Sam must ask Farah to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting. The record must not turn quote gathering into an order or claim that signage has been rejected.

PEOPLE / Sam: Administrative assistant | Farah: Meeting chair

CLOSE WITH ACTIONS THAT SURVIVE OUTSIDE THE ROOM

People can leave the same meeting remembering different levels of agreement. Repeat the owner, deliverable, and due date before closing. Distinguish a decision to gather information from a purchase decision, and record a deferred item without making it disappear.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

- A A new travel policy
- C Printer replacement

- B A payment dispute
- D Visitor signage

2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

- A Installed visitor signage
- C Two quotations

- B A guaranteed supplier discount
- D An approved printer purchase

3. What is the status of signage?

- A Rejected permanently
- C Approved for immediate spending

- B Already installed
- D To be deferred to the next meeting

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

agenda

Ordered list of topics for a meeting.

IN USE work through the agenda

agenda item

Individual topic listed for discussion.

IN USE prioritize an agenda item

chair

Person directing the meeting.

IN USE ask the chair to confirm

booklet imposition

Arrangement of document pages on print sheets so the folded booklet reads in the correct order.

IN USE confirm booklet imposition

priority item

Topic selected for attention before others.

IN USE identify the priority item

quotation

Supplier statement of a price and relevant terms.

IN USE obtain two quotations

quote gathering

Collecting supplier offers for later comparison.

IN USE assign quote gathering

purchase approval

Permission to buy the specified item.

IN USE distinguish purchase approval

action point

Agreed task arising from a discussion.

IN USE confirm the action point

action owner

Person responsible for completing the stated task.

IN USE name the action owner

deliverable

Specific output that a task is meant to produce.

IN USE define the deliverable

due date

Date by which a stated task should be completed.

IN USE record the due date

Precision check

Sam is the action owner. The deliverable is two quotes, due Thursday. No purchase has been approved. Obtaining prices and terms prepares a later decision; it does not establish supplier selection, an order, or installation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

minutes

Formal or agreed record of a meeting's proceedings.

IN USE correct the minutes

decision log

Record of decisions and their scope.

IN USE update the decision log

deferred item

Topic moved to a later discussion.

IN USE retain the deferred item

duplex printing

Printing on both sides of a physical sheet.

IN USE specify duplex printing

carry forward

Keep an unresolved item for later attention.

IN USE carry forward visitor signage

procurement

Process of obtaining goods or services for an organization.

IN USE distinguish procurement stages

supplier comparison

Review of relevant differences between supplier offers.

IN USE prepare a supplier comparison

budget authority

Permission to commit funds within an identified scope.

IN USE confirm budget authority

motion

Formal proposal presented for a meeting's decision where that procedure applies.

IN USE distinguish a motion from discussion

consensus

Shared agreement among the relevant participants.

IN USE verify consensus

action readback

Spoken summary of the task and its limits.

IN USE give an action readback

open item

Matter not yet resolved or completed.

IN USE preserve an open item

Precision check

Visitor signage is deferred to the next meeting, not rejected or completed. The final ten minutes should produce a precise action record. Do not invent a quotation deadline earlier than Thursday or a new date for the next meeting.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

SIGNAL THE TIME

"We have ten minutes left."

ASK FOR DIRECTION

"Which item should take priority?"

OFFER A BOUNDED ACTION

"I can obtain two quotes by Thursday."

DEFINE THE OUTPUT

"The deliverable is two supplier quotes."

NAME THE COMPETING ITEMS

"Printer replacement and visitor signage are still on the agenda."

CONFIRM THE PRIORITY

"We will use the remaining time for the printer item."

NAME THE OWNER

"Sam will gather the quotations."

KEEP APPROVAL SEPARATE

"No purchase has been approved."

Can obtain

Offers a specific deliverable within the speaker's stated capacity.

By Thursday

Gives the due date rather than the meeting date.

As the action point

Requests confirmation of the task to be recorded.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID AN ACCIDENTAL ORDER

"Gathering quotes does not authorize me to buy."

RECORD THE DEADLINE

"I will put Thursday in the action record."

AVOID FALSE REJECTION

"Deferred does not mean rejected."

READ BACK THE OUTCOME

"Sam: two quotes by Thursday; purchase not approved."

ASK FOR CONFIRMATION

"Can you confirm that as the action point?"

DEFER TRANSPARENTLY

"Shall we carry signage forward to the next meeting?"

PRESERVE THE OPEN ITEM

"Signage remains on the follow-up agenda."

CLOSE WITH SHARED WORDING

"I will circulate the record with those limits clear."

Does not authorize

Separates preparation from spending permission.

Carry forward

Keeps an item active for later consideration.

With those limits

Preserves the boundary of what was actually agreed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which action record is correct?

- A** Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved
- B** Sam to buy a printer today
- C** Farah has selected a supplier
- D** Signage installed by Thursday

2. What does deferred mean here?

- A** Removed from all records
- B** Moved to the next meeting
- C** Rejected permanently
- D** Approved for immediate purchase

3. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

- A** May I erase the signage item?
- B** Which supplier did we already order from?
- C** Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?
- D** Should I assume all spending is approved?

4. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

- A** Sam owns the quote action
- B** Signage remains unresolved
- C** A printer order is authorized
- D** Two quotes are needed

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Two quotes, not permission to buy

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

purchase approval / decision log / deliverable / due date / priority item / action owner / action readback / deferred item / open item / minutes

- 01 **Sam:** We've got ten minutes left and two items: printer replacement and visitor signage. Which should take the remaining time?
- 02 **Farah:** Make the printer the ¹ _____. Let's agree a useful next step rather than rush through both topics.
- 03 **Sam:** I can get two supplier quotes by Thursday. That will let us compare the offers, but it won't settle which printer to buy.
- 04 **Farah:** That's the ² _____ I need: two quotations. We haven't selected a supplier or authorized an order.
- 05 **Sam:** Shall I put my name against that action? I don't want the minutes to leave it as someone to get prices.
- 06 **Farah:** Yes, you're the ³ _____, Sam. Please record the two-quote task against your name.
- 07 **Sam:** I'll keep Thursday as the deadline, then. I haven't offered tomorrow, even though the replacement is becoming urgent.
- 08 **Farah:** Thursday is the agreed ⁴ _____. Don't move it earlier in the minutes without checking whether that's achievable.
- 09 **Sam:** Can I put no order approved on the same line? A short note saying printer quotes can sound like the purchase is already agreed.
- 10 **Farah:** Yes. There is no ⁵ _____. We're gathering information for a later decision, not giving you spending authority.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Sam:** That leaves signage. Shall I carry it to the next meeting rather than mark it resolved because we've run out of time?
- 12 **Farah:** Record it as a ⁶ _____. It hasn't been rejected or completed; we still need to discuss it.
- 13 **Sam:** I'll include both outcomes in the summary, so signage doesn't disappear when people only read the action list.
- 14 **Farah:** Good. The ⁷ _____ should distinguish the confirmed printer task from the postponed signage discussion.
- 15 **Sam:** Here's the printer line: Sam to obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved and no supplier selected.
- 16 **Farah:** That's an accurate ⁸ _____. Keep the approval limit attached so it survives if the action is copied elsewhere.
- 17 **Sam:** For signage, I'll say next meeting. I haven't got a confirmed date for that meeting to add.
- 18 **Farah:** That's enough. It remains an ⁹ _____, with the next discussion identified but no invented date.
- 19 **Sam:** Then I have one task with an owner and deadline, and one item carried forward. I'll circulate that wording.
- 20 **Farah:** Please do. The ¹⁰ _____ needs to show what we agreed, not turn preparation into a purchase decision.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. priority item | 2. deliverable | 3. action owner | 4. due date | 5. purchase approval | 6. deferred item | 7. minutes | 8. action readback | 9. open item | 10. decision log

Close the meeting with a precise action record

F Say it

Complete the action summary. Preserve the quotation task, deadline, and unresolved signage item.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quotations / Thursday / Sam / deferred

Chair: "The action owner is ¹ _____."

Assistant: "I will obtain two ² _____."

Chair: "The due date is ³ _____."

Assistant: "Visitor signage is ⁴ _____ to the next meeting."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. Sam | 2. quotations | 3. Thursday | 4. deferred

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the meeting-close dialogue.
2. Read Sam's action and Farah's confirmation aloud: two quotes by Thursday, no purchase approval. Then read the separate signage deferral.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the two outcomes without turning either into a spending decision.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Correct version, missing permission

A Read the situation

04

Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

Assistant Elena sent version 2 of the visitor guide. Version 3 was approved this morning, and the older guide gives the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder, but recipient Kai cannot view it. Elena must identify the correction, direct recipients to approved version 3, and ask the document owner to resolve Kai's viewing access. The correct floor number and the identity of the owner are not supplied; neither should be invented.

PEOPLE / Kai: Guide recipient | Elena: Administrative assistant

OWN THE CORRECTION AND SEPARATE THE ACCESS PROBLEM

An apology should point clearly to the replacement source. A broken permission is a second issue, not a reason to recirculate the inaccurate attachment or make the folder available to everyone. Describe the access needed and route the request to the owner.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which version is current?

- A Version 2 because it was emailed
- C An invented version 4

- B Both versions equally
- D Version 3, approved this morning

2. What is wrong in version 2?

- A The meeting duration
- C The supplier quantity

- B The reception floor
- D A confirmed ticket price

3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

- A Elena by making the folder public
- C Any recipient by guessing a password

- B Kai by forwarding the old version
- D The document owner through the appropriate process

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

document version

Identified revision of a file or publication.

IN USE check the document version

approved version

Revision accepted for the stated use.

IN USE use the approved version

superseded

Replaced by a newer applicable version.

IN USE mark the guide as superseded

current guide

Document presently valid for the intended purpose.

IN USE link to the current guide

shared folder

Storage location available to users with relevant permissions.

IN USE locate the shared folder

document owner

Person responsible for the file and relevant access decisions.

IN USE contact the document owner

viewing access

Permission to open and read the content.

IN USE request viewing access

editing permission

Authority to modify the content.

IN USE distinguish editing permission

access request

Request for an appropriate permission to be granted.

IN USE submit an access request

permission scope

Range of people and actions covered by an access setting.

IN USE preserve permission scope

mail merge

Creation of personalized documents by combining a template with selected source records.

IN USE preview the mail merge

attachment

File included with a message.

IN USE replace the outdated attachment

Precision check

Version 3 was approved this morning. Version 2 contains the wrong reception floor and should not remain the active guide. The brief does not supply the correct floor number, so the correction must point to the current guide rather than invent directions.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

document link

Address pointing to a stored file.

IN USE share the current document link

version history

Record of changes or saved revisions.

IN USE consult version history

approval date

Date on which the relevant revision was accepted.

IN USE verify the approval date

correction notice

Message identifying an error and its replacement.

IN USE send a correction notice

merge field

Placeholder that inserts a specified source value into a personalized document.

IN USE verify the merge field

access error

Message or condition preventing permitted use of a resource.

IN USE report an access error

distribution list

Set of recipients for a message or document.

IN USE check the distribution list

unrestricted link

Link that does not limit access to the intended named audience.

IN USE avoid an unrestricted link

read-only

Allowing viewing without permission to change content.

IN USE request read-only access

source location

Place where the authoritative file is stored.

IN USE identify the source location

revision control

Management of document versions and their status.

IN USE maintain revision control

replacement message

Updated communication that corrects an earlier one.

IN USE issue a replacement message

Precision check

Kai needs viewing access, not an assumed right to edit or share with everyone. Elena should ask the document owner to resolve the problem through the appropriate process. A shared folder is not necessarily open to every recipient.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OWN THE ERROR

"I sent version 2 in my earlier message."

IDENTIFY THE AFFECTED DETAIL

"The older guide gives the wrong reception floor."

AVOID GUESSED DIRECTIONS

"I will not quote a floor number I have not verified."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE OBSTACLE

"You are receiving an access error."

NAME THE REPLACEMENT

"Version 3 was approved this morning."

DIRECT RECIPIENTS CLEARLY

"Please use version 3 in the shared folder."

ASK ABOUT ACCESS

"Can you open the current guide?"

NAME THE NEEDED PERMISSION

"You need viewing access to the approved guide."

Superseded

Marks the older version as replaced rather than still equally valid.

Approved this morning

Specifies why version 3 is current.

Can you open ...?

Checks viewing access without asking for an edit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP EDITING SEPARATE

"Viewing access is not a request for editing rights."

AVOID WIDENING ACCESS

"I will not make the folder available to everyone."

CORRECT THE DISTRIBUTION

"I will send the correction to the affected recipients."

KEEP COMPLETION HONEST

"Access has been requested, not confirmed."

ROUTE THE REQUEST

"I will ask the document owner to resolve the permission."

RETIRE THE OLD REFERENCE

"The earlier attachment is superseded."

PRESERVE THE AUTHORITATIVE SOURCE

"The current file remains in the shared folder."

CLOSE WITH TWO ACTIONS

"Replace the outdated reference and resolve viewing access."

Requested, not confirmed

Distinguishes submission from successful resolution.

Affected recipients

Identifies the relevant audience without expanding distribution.

I will not quote

Prevents guessed location information from entering the correction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction is accurate?

- A** Use either version because both arrived by email
- B** Reception is on an invented floor
- C** Version 4 has automatically replaced both files
- D** Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

2. What permission does Kai need here?

- A** Permission to edit every file
- B** A public link for anyone
- C** Viewing access
- D** Ownership of the folder

3. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

- A** Making the folder public
- B** Asking the owner for viewing access
- C** Correcting the earlier message
- D** Identifying version 2 as superseded

4. What should Elena avoid claiming?

- A** Version 2 gives the wrong floor
- B** The owner should receive the request
- C** Kai's access is fixed before confirmation
- D** Version 3 was approved this morning

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

Correct version, missing permission

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved version / current guide / document owner / correction notice / access request / replacement message / access error / permission scope / viewing access / superseded

- 01 **Kai:** I've got your emailed visitor guide and a message about a newer one. Which should I use for the people arriving today?
- 02 **Elena:** Use the ¹ _____, version 3, approved this morning. I sent version 2 earlier, and its reception-floor information is wrong. I'm sorry for the confusion.
- 03 **Kai:** Can you tell me the correct floor now? I don't want to forward two different sets of directions.
- 04 **Elena:** I need to verify it in the ² _____. I won't guess a number; version 3 in the shared folder is the replacement source.
- 05 **Kai:** I tried that link. It says I don't have permission, so I can only open the old attachment.
- 06 **Elena:** Then you need ³ _____ to version 3. I'll ask the document owner to resolve that separately from correcting my earlier message.
- 07 **Kai:** Could you just make the link open to anyone? That might be quicker than waiting for the owner.
- 08 **Elena:** I shouldn't widen the ⁴ _____ on my own. I'll request access for you, not open the folder to an unrestricted audience.
- 09 **Kai:** I only need to read it. Please don't ask for editing rights on my behalf.
- 10 **Elena:** I'll make the ⁵ _____ specific: Kai needs to view the approved visitor guide, version 3, and the current link returns an error.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Kai:** While that's pending, should I leave the old attachment in the visitor email as a temporary fallback?
- 12 **Elena:** No. It's ⁶ _____ and contains a known error. Leaving it as the active guide would keep sending people to the wrong place.
- 13 **Kai:** Please make the correction easy to spot. There are several messages in the thread, and a quiet edit would be missed.
- 14 **Elena:** I'll send a clear ⁷ _____ identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and version 3 as its replacement.
- 15 **Kai:** Once you've sent the owner the request, can I tell my colleague the link is fixed?
- 16 **Elena:** Not yet. The ⁸ _____ remains unresolved until the permission and actual access are confirmed. I'll describe the request as pending.
- 17 **Kai:** So one action corrects the information for everyone who received it, and the other resolves my ability to open the right file.
- 18 **Elena:** Exactly. The ⁹ _____ will correct the reference, while the access request stays visible as a separate follow-up.
- 19 **Kai:** Thank you. I won't forward version 2 or say I can open version 3 until it's working.
- 20 **Elena:** I'll keep the ¹⁰ _____ involved and report the confirmed status. The next update won't invent a floor number or claim the access change is complete.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. approved version | 2. current guide | 3. viewing access | 4. permission scope | 5. access request | 6. superseded | 7. correction notice | 8. access error | 9. replacement message | 10. document owner

Correct the guide and request the right access

F Say it

Complete the document handoff. Identify the current version, the known error, and the appropriate permission route.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

floor / viewing / owner / 3

Assistant: "The approved guide is version ¹ _____."

Recipient: "The older version has the wrong reception ² _____."

Assistant: "You need ³ _____ access to the current guide."

Recipient: "Please ask the document ⁴ _____ to resolve it."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 3 | 2. floor | 3. viewing | 4. owner

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the version-and-access dialogue.
2. Read the correction and access request aloud. Name version 3, the outdated reception-floor detail, viewing access, and the document owner.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Keep access requested separate from access confirmed.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

A Read the situation

Present a documented quantity discrepancy and request the missing supply information without inventing a cause or approving payment.

05

Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note also lists twelve, but assistant Omar has checked the shipment and counted ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Supplier contact Leila must receive a factual query asking about the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. Omar has no basis to allege theft, assume a split delivery, or approve payment from the information available.

PEOPLE / Omar: Office assistant | Leila: Supplier contact

USE MATCHING REFERENCES AND NEUTRAL DISCREPANCY LANGUAGE

A clear supplier query separates the order, the document, and the checked physical count. Ask for confirmation of the outstanding quantity and delivery position. An unexplained difference is not proof of dishonesty, and a document alone does not establish receipt.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A Twelve

C Two

B Ten

D Twenty-two

2. What quantity was physically checked?

A An uncounted second package

C Twelve boxes

B Ten boxes

D Two boxes

3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A Nothing is confirmed

C It was received yesterday

B It definitely arrives tomorrow

D It has been canceled by Omar

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

purchase order

Formal order record specifying requested goods or services; abbreviated PO.

IN USE quote the purchase order

archive box

Container used to store records or documents.

IN USE order archive boxes

ordered quantity

Number of units requested on the order.

IN USE verify the ordered quantity

delivery note

Document listing goods associated with a delivery.

IN USE compare the delivery note

checked count

Quantity established by the stated physical check.

IN USE report the checked count

short delivery

Receipt of fewer units than the order or document specifies.

IN USE query a short delivery

quantity discrepancy

Difference between relevant stated or counted quantities.

IN USE report a quantity discrepancy

outstanding quantity

Ordered amount not yet accounted for as received.

IN USE confirm the outstanding quantity

backorder

Order quantity awaiting later fulfillment.

IN USE verify a documented backorder

split shipment

Order delivered in more than one consignment.

IN USE confirm a split shipment

second package

Additional parcel distinct from the checked one.

IN USE verify a second package

shipment plan

Stated arrangement for dispatching the remaining goods.

IN USE request the shipment plan

Precision check

Twelve were ordered and twelve appear on the delivery note, but ten were checked in the shipment. The difference is two. Do not change the checked count to match the paper or claim that the missing two have already been dispatched.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

supplier query

Request to clarify information held by the vendor.

IN USE raise a supplier query

order reference

Identifier connecting an inquiry to the correct order.

IN USE include the order reference

receipt record

Account of goods actually received.

IN USE preserve the receipt record

dispatch record

Information documenting goods sent from the supplier.

IN USE check the dispatch record

packing list

List describing the contents assigned to a package or shipment.

IN USE compare the packing list

unit count

Number of individual items rather than cartons or sets.

IN USE confirm the unit count

fulfillment

Completion of the relevant supply obligation.

IN USE distinguish partial fulfillment

partial receipt

Receipt of only part of the ordered amount.

IN USE record a partial receipt

payment approval

Authorization to pay the relevant charge.

IN USE keep payment approval separate

supplier response

Information returned in answer to the query.

IN USE request a supplier response

unverified explanation

Possible cause not established by the evidence.

IN USE avoid an unverified explanation

delivery reconciliation

Comparison of order, documents, and received quantities.

IN USE complete delivery reconciliation

Precision check

The supplier should confirm the outstanding quantity and whether another shipment is planned. No documented backorder, second package, theft, or payment approval is supplied. Keep the discrepancy open until the relevant evidence resolves it.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER

"I am calling about purchase order P44."

STATE THE DOCUMENT AMOUNT

"The delivery note also lists twelve."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"Two boxes are not accounted for in this receipt."

ASK ABOUT OUTSTANDING SUPPLY

"Can you confirm the outstanding two boxes?"

STATE THE ORDERED AMOUNT

"The order is for twelve archive boxes."

STATE THE CHECKED COUNT

"We checked the shipment and counted ten."

USE NEUTRAL LANGUAGE

"There is a quantity discrepancy to resolve."

CHECK FOR ANOTHER SHIPMENT

"Is a further shipment planned?"

Lists versus counted

Separates what a document says from the physical check.

Not accounted for

Describes an unresolved quantity without assigning blame.

Further shipment

Asks about a possibility without claiming it exists.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID ASSUMING A BACKORDER

"We have no documented backorder."

AVOID INVENTING A PACKAGE

"No second package is recorded."

SEPARATE DOCUMENT AND RECEIPT

"The note lists twelve, but our checked receipt is ten."

REQUEST THE SUPPORTING RECORD

"Please check the dispatch information against P44."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"We have not established why the quantities differ."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"I am reporting the count, not alleging theft."

PRESERVE APPROVAL LIMITS

"This query does not approve payment."

CLOSE WITH THE REQUESTED RESPONSE

"Please confirm the remaining quantity and shipment position."

Against P44

Anchors the check to the correct order.

No documented

Limits the statement to available records rather than claiming absolute impossibility.

Does not approve

Prevents a query from becoming a financial authorization.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

- A** P44 orders ten and all twelve arrived
- B** The note proves twelve were received
- C** Two additional boxes have definitely shipped
- D** P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

2. What is the outstanding difference?

- A** Twenty-two boxes
- B** Two boxes
- C** Twelve boxes
- D** Ten boxes

3. Which question is justified?

- A** Can I record a second delivery as completed?
- B** Which payment have we already approved?
- C** Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?
- D** Why did your driver steal two boxes?

4. Which record should remain accurate?

- A** An invented receipt of twelve
- B** A confirmed backorder with no evidence
- C** An automatic payment approval
- D** The checked receipt of ten

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

supplier query / order reference / supplier response / split shipment / ordered quantity / dispatch record / Payment approval / checked count / outstanding quantity / quantity discrepancy

- 01 **Omar:** Could you check P44, our archive-box order? The quantity on the paperwork doesn't match what we received.
- 02 **Leila:** Certainly. Please give me the ¹ _____ first, then the delivery-note figure and your checked count. That will help me keep the three records separate.
- 03 **Omar:** We ordered twelve. The note says twelve too, but I've checked the shipment and counted ten.
- 04 **Leila:** Then the ² _____ is two boxes. I will not treat the delivery-note figure as proof that twelve were physically received at your office.
- 05 **Omar:** There isn't a second package or backorder recorded here. Has something been sent separately?
- 06 **Leila:** Understood. A ³ _____ has not been documented in the information you have. I need to check rather than tell you another package is already on its way.
- 07 **Omar:** Please confirm the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. I need both points answered.
- 08 **Leila:** I will check the ⁴ _____ against P44 and ask about the shipment position. At this point, I do not have a confirmed dispatch date to give you.
- 09 **Omar:** Keep archive boxes beside P44, please. We've got several office-supply orders open.
- 10 **Leila:** I will retain the ⁵ _____ and the archive-box description together. The query is twelve ordered, twelve on the note, ten checked, with two outstanding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Omar:** Should I leave the receiving record at ten while you check? Someone suggested matching it to the delivery note.
- 12 **Leila:** You should preserve the ⁶ _____ of ten in this query. We need to resolve the mismatch, not make it disappear by replacing the physical count with the document figure.
- 13 **Omar:** I want to report the difference without blaming the driver. We don't know why it happened.
- 14 **Leila:** Agreed. The ⁷ _____ can ask for confirmation without alleging theft or blaming a particular person. The current evidence does not establish a cause.
- 15 **Omar:** Could you compare the dispatch record with P44? I don't want to assume the missing two were held back.
- 16 **Leila:** I will request the relevant ⁸ _____ check. I will not say the boxes were held back unless the information supports that explanation.
- 17 **Omar:** And this query isn't payment approval or permission to close the discrepancy.
- 18 **Leila:** Understood. ⁹ _____ is not part of this exchange. The query remains open while the outstanding quantity and any further shipment are being confirmed.
- 19 **Omar:** Please come back with the quantity and shipment position, not just an acknowledgment that you received the query.
- 20 **Leila:** I will make the requested ¹⁰ _____ specific to those questions. Until then, the record remains ten received against twelve ordered, with two still unaccounted for.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. ordered quantity | 2. quantity discrepancy | 3. split shipment | 4. outstanding quantity | 5. order reference | 6. checked count | 7. supplier query | 8. dispatch record | 9. Payment approval | 10. supplier response

State the supply discrepancy without guessing

F Say it

Complete the supplier query using the documented order and checked receipt.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ten / two / P44 / twelve

Assistant: "The purchase order is ¹ _____."

Supplier: "The order and delivery note both list ² _____ boxes."

Assistant: "The checked shipment contains ³ _____ boxes."

Supplier: "The outstanding difference is ⁴ _____ boxes."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. P44 | 2. twelve | 3. ten | 4. two

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the supplier-query dialogue.
2. Read the quantities aloud: twelve ordered, twelve on the note, ten counted, two outstanding. Then ask the supplied further-shipment question.
3. Complete the transfer, check the key, and reread the factual query without adding a cause or payment approval.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

A Read the situation

Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. Two colleagues share that first name: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Visitor reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Receptionist Nia must check the reference, contact the correct host, and explain that Taylor should wait at reception. Taylor is not cleared to enter other areas alone. No host arrival time or further access permission has been confirmed.

PEOPLE / Taylor: Visitor | Nia: Receptionist

06

WARMTH AND VERIFICATION BELONG IN THE SAME WELCOME

A friendly reception need not rely on guessing who a visitor means. Explain the small ambiguity, use the appointment reference, and say what happens next. A waiting instruction should sound like a clear arrangement, not a personal suspicion or an invented promise about the host.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

A Both Jordans jointly

C Jordan Chen in facilities

B An unnamed finance colleague

D Jordan Patel in sales

2. Where should Taylor wait?

A In any available meeting room

C At reception

B At the sales desk without checking

D Alone in the facilities work area

3. What is not confirmed?

A The scheduled 10:00 meeting

C When the host will reach reception

B The existence of two Jordans

D The reference V12

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

reception

Area where visitors first report and are assisted.

IN USE wait at reception

visitor reference

Identifier linking a visitor to an arrangement.

IN USE check the visitor reference

host

Person responsible for receiving the visitor.

IN USE contact the host

appointment record

Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting.

IN USE check the appointment record

surname

Family name used to distinguish people with the same first name.

IN USE confirm the surname

facilities

Workplace function associated with relevant building services.

IN USE identify the facilities host

sales

Business function associated with selling products or services.

IN USE distinguish the sales colleague

scheduled time

Time recorded for the arranged meeting.

IN USE confirm the scheduled time

arrival

Visitor's appearance at the location.

IN USE acknowledge the arrival

check-in

Initial process for recording or verifying a visitor's arrival.

IN USE complete the check-in

waiting area

Designated place where a person remains before being received.

IN USE explain the waiting area

host notification

Message informing the host that the visitor has arrived.

IN USE send the host notification

Precision check

Reference V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities, not Jordan Patel in sales. The first name alone is insufficient because both colleagues are called Jordan. Preserve the reference and full name when contacting the host.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

access clearance

Confirmed permission to enter a defined area.

IN USE verify access clearance

unaccompanied access

Permission to enter or move without an escort.

IN USE distinguish unaccompanied access

escort

Authorized person accompanying a visitor where required.

IN USE confirm the escort arrangement

visitor badge

Identifier issued under the relevant visitor procedure.

IN USE follow the visitor-badge procedure

visitor log

Record of arrivals and relevant visit details.

IN USE update the visitor log

restricted area

Space whose entry is limited by the applicable rules.

IN USE identify a restricted area

identity match

Agreement between the person or name and the relevant record.

IN USE verify the identity match

appointment ambiguity

Uncertainty about which arrangement or host is intended.

IN USE resolve appointment ambiguity

reception wait

Period spent at reception pending the next arrangement.

IN USE explain the reception wait

host availability

Whether the intended host can presently respond.

IN USE check host availability

arrival estimate

Expected arrival time that has not necessarily been confirmed.

IN USE qualify an arrival estimate

visitor handoff

Transfer of responsibility for receiving the visitor.

IN USE coordinate the visitor handoff

Precision check

The appointment is scheduled for 10:00, but the host's immediate availability has not been confirmed. Taylor should wait at reception and has no clearance to enter other areas alone. Do not invent a two-minute wait, badge requirement, or escort arrival.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN WARMLY

"Good morning. Who are you here to see?"

EXPLAIN THE AMBIGUITY

"We have two colleagues called Jordan."

READ BACK THE IDENTIFIER

"I have V12."

DISTINGUISH THE DEPARTMENT

"Jordan Chen is in facilities, not sales."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE BOOKING

"You have a 10:00 meeting with Jordan."

ASK FOR THE REFERENCE

"May I check your visitor reference?"

CONFIRM THE FULL NAME

"That reference names Jordan Chen."

STATE THE NEXT ACTION

"I will contact your host."

06

We have two

Explains why a clarification is necessary without blaming the visitor.

That reference names

Grounds the identification in a record rather than a guess.

While I contact

Connects the wait with the next action without giving a false duration.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN THE WAIT

"Please wait here at reception while I contact Jordan."

AVOID INVENTED TIMING

"I do not yet have a confirmed arrival time for the host."

SEPARATE APPOINTMENT AND ENTRY

"The meeting reference does not give unaccompanied access."

CHECK THE UNDERSTANDING

"Is the host name on that readback correct?"

KEEP THE TONE HELPFUL

"I want to make sure you reach the correct person."

KEEP ACCESS EXPLICIT

"You are not cleared to enter the other areas alone."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"I will keep V12 with your arrival message."

CLOSE WITH THE ARRANGEMENT

"Jordan Chen will be contacted; please remain at reception for the next update."

Not yet

States an unresolved fact without denying a possible later arrangement.

Alone

Specifies the unaccompanied-access boundary.

Please remain

Gives a courteous, concrete waiting instruction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which host message is accurate?

- A** Taylor is meeting Jordan Patel in sales
- B** Both Jordans must attend
- C** Taylor has entered facilities alone
- D** Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

- A** Your appointment means you can enter alone
- B** Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen
- C** Go anywhere while we look for Jordan
- D** Jordan will definitely be here in two minutes

3. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

- A** V12 and the full host name
- B** Assuming sales receives every visitor
- C** Choosing the first Jordan in a directory
- D** Treating both names as interchangeable

4. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

- A** The reference V12
- B** Jordan Chen's department
- C** Permission to enter other areas alone
- D** The scheduled 10:00 meeting

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

waiting area / appointment record / visitor handoff / reception wait / host availability / visitor reference / arrival / host notification / surname / unaccompanied access

06

- 01 **Taylor:** Good morning, Taylor here for a ten o'clock meeting with Jordan. I've got the confirmation on my phone.
- 02 **Nia:** Welcome. May I check the ¹ _____? We have two colleagues called Jordan, so I want to contact the right person before directing you anywhere.
- 03 **Taylor:** It's V12. I remembered Jordan's first name but not the surname.
- 04 **Nia:** Thank you. The ² _____ names Jordan Chen in facilities. The other colleague is Jordan Patel in sales, so we have resolved that ambiguity.
- 05 **Taylor:** Yes, Jordan Chen is right. I might have ended up in sales if you hadn't checked.
- 06 **Nia:** I will send the ³ _____ to Jordan Chen, using V12 and your name. Please wait here at reception while I make contact.
- 07 **Taylor:** Do you know if Jordan's already coming down? The meeting is at ten.
- 08 **Nia:** I have not confirmed ⁴ _____ yet. I can contact Jordan, but I do not want to promise an arrival time before I have that information.
- 09 **Taylor:** Could I wait near the facilities office instead, so I'm easier to find?
- 10 **Nia:** Please remain in the ⁵ _____ here for now. You have not been cleared to enter the other areas alone, and I do not want to send you beyond the current arrangement.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Taylor:** Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough to go through.
- 12 **Nia:** Yes. The reference identifies your visit; it does not itself establish
6 _____. I will keep the next step clear while we contact the correct host.
- 13 **Taylor:** Please tell Jordan I've arrived, rather than just asking whether the meeting's still on.
- 14 **Nia:** Certainly. The 7 _____ message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.
- 15 **Taylor:** Reception is fine. I don't need a different room; I just need Jordan to know where I am.
- 16 **Nia:** I will keep the 8 _____ as the arrangement. No alternative room or entry route has been agreed, so I will not add one to the message.
- 17 **Taylor:** Could you repeat the full name and department once? I'd like to use the right surname.
- 18 **Nia:** Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the 9 _____ prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.
- 19 **Taylor:** Thank you. I'll stay here for the next update.
- 20 **Nia:** You are welcome. I will coordinate the 10 _____ once the host response is available. For now, the correct host has been identified and the waiting instruction is clear.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. visitor reference | 2. appointment record | 3. host notification | 4. host availability | 5. waiting area | 6. unaccompanied access | 7. arrival | 8. reception wait | 9. surname | 10. visitor handoff

Welcome the visitor and identify the correct host

F Say it

Complete the reception readback using the reference and the actual waiting arrangement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reception / Chen / facilities / V12

Receptionist: "The visitor reference is ¹ _____."

Visitor: "I am meeting Jordan ² _____."

Receptionist: "Your host works in ³ _____."

Visitor: "I will wait at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. V12 | 2. Chen | 3. facilities | 4. reception

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the reception dialogue.
2. Read the welcome and waiting exchanges aloud. Keep V12, Jordan Chen in facilities, 10:00, and reception together.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Reread the waiting instruction without inventing a host-arrival time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A higher fare with a conditional refund

A Read the situation

Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. Option A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable. Option B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure with a \$10 deduction. Traveler Mira's meeting is not yet confirmed, and purchasing approval is still required. Assistant Ben must compare the quoted terms accurately without choosing for Mira, promising a full refund, or treating the discussion as authority to book.

07

PEOPLE / Mira: Traveler | Ben: Administrative assistant

EXPLAIN THE CONDITION AS CAREFULLY AS THE PRICE

The word refundable can hide a deadline and a deduction. State the upfront price, the condition, and the resulting amount together. A useful comparison helps an authorized decision without turning the assistant's explanation into a booking or financial recommendation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A \$20

B \$10

C \$80

D \$160

2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

A \$70

B No refund under any circumstances

C \$80

D \$90

3. What must happen before purchase?

A Obtain the required purchasing approval

B Treat this discussion as a booking

C Assume the meeting is confirmed

D Ignore the quoted conditions

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

rail quote

Stated price and conditions for a proposed train journey.

IN USE compare rail quotes

fare

Price charged for the specified travel.

IN USE state the fare

nonrefundable

Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms.

IN USE identify a nonrefundable fare

refundable

Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions.

IN USE qualify refundable

deduction

Amount subtracted from a payment or refund.

IN USE explain the deduction

before departure

Earlier than the stated leaving time.

IN USE preserve the before-departure condition

refund amount

Sum returned under the applicable refund terms.

IN USE calculate the refund amount

upfront cost

Amount paid at the time of purchase.

IN USE compare upfront costs

price difference

Amount by which one price exceeds another.

IN USE state the price difference

quoted terms

Conditions included in the supplied offer.

IN USE preserve the quoted terms

booking status

Current stage of a travel reservation or purchase.

IN USE clarify booking status

purchasing approval

Required permission to commit the organization to a purchase.

IN USE obtain purchasing approval

Precision check

A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable under these quoted terms. B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure less \$10, leaving \$80. B costs \$20 more upfront; the \$10 deduction is not the price difference.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

unconfirmed meeting

Meeting whose occurrence or arrangement is not yet settled.

IN USE identify the unconfirmed meeting

itinerary

Planned sequence and details of travel.

IN USE check the itinerary

cash advance

Money provided before eligible expenses are settled, to be reconciled against the applicable claim.

IN USE reconcile the cash advance

cancellation

Withdrawal from an existing booking under its terms.

IN USE distinguish cancellation from comparison

refund eligibility

Whether the relevant conditions for a refund are met.

IN USE check refund eligibility

fare condition

Restriction or permission attached to a ticket price.

IN USE explain the fare condition

expense itemization

Separation of an expense into its component amounts and categories.

IN USE check expense itemization

net refund

Amount returned after the stated deduction.

IN USE calculate the net refund

travel authorization

Approval for travel within a defined scope.

IN USE distinguish travel authorization

reservation

Arrangement holding travel space under specified terms.

IN USE verify a reservation

ticket issuance

Creation or provision of the actual travel ticket.

IN USE distinguish ticket issuance

conditional comparison

Explanation that preserves the conditions affecting the alternatives.

IN USE give a conditional comparison

Precision check

The \$80 refund applies only under the supplied before-departure condition. Do not invent later refund rights, transferability, fees, or legal protections. The meeting is unconfirmed and purchasing approval is still needed; no ticket has been authorized by this comparison.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

DEFINE THE COMPARISON

"Both quotes cover the same trip."

STATE OPTION B

"B costs \$90."

INCLUDE THE DEDUCTION

"The refund is reduced by \$10."

COMPARE UPFRONT PRICES

"B costs \$20 more upfront."

STATE OPTION A

"A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable."

INCLUDE THE CONDITION

"B permits a refund before departure."

CALCULATE THE RETURNED AMOUNT

"Ninety minus ten leaves an \$80 refund."

AVOID A FULL-REFUND CLAIM

"Refundable does not mean the full \$90 comes back."

07

Subject to

Introduces a condition that limits a general statement.

Before departure

Defines when the stated refund permission applies.

Less ten

Expresses the deduction from the ninety-dollar payment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP LATER TERMS OPEN

"No after-departure refund terms are supplied here."

KEEP THE CHOICE SEPARATE

"I can explain the options without choosing for you."

AVOID AN ACCIDENTAL BOOKING

"This comparison is not a ticket purchase."

REQUEST THE NEXT DECISION

"Please confirm the authorized choice before any booking."

PRESERVE MEETING STATUS

"Your meeting is not confirmed yet."

STATE THE APPROVAL REQUIREMENT

"Purchasing approval is still required."

DISTINGUISH THE TWO AMOUNTS

"The \$20 premium and \$10 deduction are different figures."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The prices and conditions are clear; the booking remains unapproved."

Upfront

Refers to the initial price rather than a later refund.

Not confirmed yet

Preserves the uncertainty about the travel purpose.

Before any booking

Keeps the approval decision ahead of spending.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is complete?

- A** B is \$90 with a guaranteed full refund anytime
- B** A and B both cost \$80
- C** B costs only \$10 more than A
- D** A is \$70 nonrefundable; B is \$90 with an \$80 refund before departure

2. What does the \$10 represent?

- A** The entire price of option A
- B** The deduction from B's refund
- C** The difference between the fares
- D** A separate confirmed booking fee

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** Approval is required
- B** B is refundable after departure without restrictions
- C** B costs \$90
- D** A costs \$70

4. Which handoff is ready for the approver?

- A** B reserved with a full refund guaranteed after departure
- B** Both quotes with conditions, meeting unconfirmed, no purchase approved
- C** B selected because its refund makes it cheaper to buy
- D** A booked because it has the lower upfront price

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A higher fare with a conditional refund

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Purchasing approval / nonrefundable / net refund / conditional comparison / fare / upfront cost / unconfirmed meeting / booking status / price difference / before departure

07

- 01 **Mira:** My meeting isn't confirmed, so please don't book yet. Could you explain the two quotes for the same rail trip?
- 02 **Ben:** Yes. Option A has a ¹ _____ of seventy dollars, and option B is ninety. The important difference is not only the price but also the refund conditions.
- 03 **Mira:** A says nonrefundable. Is that the condition we're using for the seventy-dollar option?
- 04 **Ben:** Correct. A is ² _____ under these quoted terms. For B, a refund is permitted before departure, but ten dollars is deducted from the amount returned.
- 05 **Mira:** For B, how much would actually come back? Refundable sounds like ninety, but there's a deduction.
- 06 **Ben:** The ³ _____ would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.
- 07 **Mira:** I nearly treated the ten dollars as the price difference. That's the amount retained from a refund, isn't it?
- 08 **Ben:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ is seventy for A or ninety for B. The ten-dollar deduction belongs to B's refund terms; it is not B's purchase price.
- 09 **Mira:** So B costs twenty more to buy, while the refund deduction is ten. Those aren't the same comparison.
- 10 **Ben:** Right. The ⁵ _____ is twenty dollars. Keeping those two figures separate prevents a misleading comparison, especially when you are explaining the options to the approver.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mira:** What happens after departure? Does this quote actually say?
- 12 **Ben:** The supplied condition is ⁶ _____. We have no later refund terms here, so I cannot extend the eighty-dollar calculation to an after-departure cancellation.
- 13 **Mira:** Please keep this as a comparison. Asking about refunds isn't an instruction to buy a ticket.
- 14 **Ben:** I will keep the ⁷ _____ clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.
- 15 **Mira:** Can you give me a short summary for the approver without saying I've selected one?
- 16 **Ben:** Certainly. The ⁸ _____ is A at seventy, nonrefundable; B at ninety, with an eighty-dollar refund before departure after the ten-dollar deduction.
- 17 **Mira:** Add that the meeting's still unconfirmed, please. That's why I'm checking the conditions.
- 18 **Ben:** I will preserve the ⁹ _____ status alongside the quotes. The decision-maker should see the actual circumstances, not a message implying that the trip is already settled.
- 19 **Mira:** I'll get the choice and purchasing approval clarified. Nothing should be booked on the strength of this conversation.
- 20 **Ben:** Agreed. ¹⁰ _____ remains outstanding. I will not issue a ticket or record an authorized choice until the required confirmation is available.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. fare | 2. nonrefundable | 3. net refund | 4. upfront cost | 5. price difference | 6. before departure | 7. booking status | 8. conditional comparison | 9. unconfirmed meeting | 10. Purchasing approval

State the price and the refund condition

F Say it

Complete the comparison using the supplied fares and terms. Do not turn the comparison into a booking.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

eighty / seventy / approval / ninety

Assistant: "Option A costs ¹ _____ dollars."

Traveler: "Option B costs ² _____ dollars."

Assistant: "Before departure, B permits an ³ _____-dollar refund."

Traveler: "Purchasing ⁴ _____ is still required."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. seventy | 2. ninety | 3. eighty | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the travel-comparison dialogue.
2. Read both quotes aloud: A \$70 nonrefundable; B \$90, refund \$80 before departure. Then read the separate approval requirement.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Keep the \$20 purchase-price difference separate from the \$10 refund deduction.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

A Read the situation

Explain a capacity conflict with concrete timings and ask the manager to select a priority or change a deadline.

At 10:00, assistant Rosa has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each requires thirty minutes. Manager Ellis requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is available to help. Rosa must explain the conflict and ask Ellis to choose priorities or adjust a deadline. The case ends with that decision still needed; Rosa cannot truthfully promise all three original deadlines.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Administrative assistant | Ellis: Manager

08

MAKE THE TRADE-OFF CONCRETE, NOT PERSONAL

Saying that you are busy does not show which commitment will move. State the existing deadlines and task durations, then ask for a priority decision. Respectful pushback gives the manager an accurate choice without silently accepting an impossible schedule or delegating to an unavailable colleague.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is due at 10:30?

A The visitor list

B The room pack

C The new spreadsheet check

D An already completed handover

2. How much work is requested in total?

A Sixty minutes

B Thirty minutes

C Twenty minutes

D Eighty minutes

3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

A Treat the durations as zero

B Choose priorities or adjust a deadline

C Assume all three will be on time

D Assign the work to an unavailable colleague

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

workload

Amount of work assigned or awaiting completion.

IN USE explain the workload

capacity

Available ability or time to carry out work.

IN USE state the capacity limit

priority decision

Choice about which task takes precedence.

IN USE request a priority decision

deadline

Latest required completion time for a task.

IN USE clarify the deadline

task duration

Time needed to perform the stated work.

IN USE specify task duration

visitor list

Record of expected visitors for the relevant arrangement.

IN USE prepare the visitor list

room pack

Set of materials prepared for use in the meeting room.

IN USE assemble the room pack

spreadsheet check

Review of the specified spreadsheet information.

IN USE perform the spreadsheet check

competing request

New demand that conflicts with existing commitments.

IN USE identify the competing request

time window

Period within which work must be performed.

IN USE define the available time window

sequence

Order in which tasks are carried out.

IN USE agree the task sequence

trade-off

Consequence of choosing one priority at the expense of another.

IN USE explain the trade-off

Precision check

At 10:00, the original two tasks already require the full sixty minutes until 11:00. The new check adds twenty minutes and is due at 10:20. Doing it first moves the earliest visitor-list finish to 10:50, beyond its 10:30 deadline.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

revised deadline

Newly agreed completion requirement.

IN USE obtain a revised deadline

displaced task

Work moved later because another task takes its place.

IN USE identify the displaced task

coverage

Availability of another person to handle work during the relevant period.

IN USE confirm coverage

delegation

Assignment of a task to someone with the relevant availability and authority.

IN USE avoid unsupported delegation

commitment

Promise to complete a defined action under stated conditions.

IN USE make a realistic commitment

overcommitment

Acceptance of more work than the available capacity permits.

IN USE avoid overcommitment

schedule impact

Effect of a change on task timing.

IN USE explain the schedule impact

earliest finish

First possible completion time under the stated sequence and durations.

IN USE calculate the earliest finish

existing obligation

Task already required before the new request arrives.

IN USE preserve existing obligations

reprioritization

Change to the order or importance of assigned work.

IN USE request reprioritization

handover coverage

Confirmed support for taking over specified work.

IN USE verify handover coverage

decision readback

Repetition of the chosen priority and its consequences.

IN USE prepare a decision readback

08

Precision check

If the sequence is spreadsheet, visitor list, then room pack, the finish times are 10:20, 10:50, and 11:20. These are consequences, not newly approved deadlines. No colleague is available, and Ellis has not yet chosen which commitment should change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20."

STATE THE FIRST DEADLINE

"The visitor list is due at 10:30."

GIVE THE DURATIONS

"Each existing task needs thirty minutes."

SHOW THE CAPACITY CONFLICT

"That is eighty minutes of work between 10:00 and 11:00."

NAME THE EXISTING WORK

"The visitor list and room pack are already due this morning."

STATE THE SECOND DEADLINE

"The room pack is due at 11:00."

ADD THE NEW DEMAND

"The spreadsheet check adds twenty minutes."

STATE THE IMMEDIATE CONSEQUENCE

"If I do the check first, the visitor list cannot finish before 10:50."

08

If I do ... first

Introduces a specific scheduling consequence rather than a refusal.

Cannot finish before

States an earliest completion under the given durations.

Would also

Extends the same conditional sequence to the later task.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP CONSEQUENCES CONDITIONAL

"That sequence would also move the room pack to 11:20."

ASK FOR A DECISION

"Which task should take priority?"

PRESERVE PRIOR COMMITMENTS

"I need to know which existing commitment should move."

REQUEST EXPLICIT AGREEMENT

"Please confirm the revised priority or deadline."

AVOID IMAGINARY HELP

"No colleague is available to take over a task."

OFFER THE RELEVANT ALTERNATIVE

"Can one of the deadlines be adjusted?"

AVOID VAGUE ASSENT

"I cannot confirm all three original deadlines."

CLOSE WITHOUT PRETENDING

"The schedule change still needs your decision."

08

Which should move?

Asks for a decision about the affected commitment.

No colleague is available

Removes delegation as an invented solution.

Still needs

Keeps an unresolved decision visible in the handoff.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

- A 11:20
- B 10:50
- C 10:20
- D 10:30

2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

- A 11:20
- B 10:50
- C 11:00
- D 10:20

3. Which response is professionally clear?

- A I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes
- B I will somehow meet every original deadline
- C Another colleague will do it despite being unavailable
- D The visitor list no longer matters without asking

4. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

- A Whether a colleague is available
- B The original visitor-list deadline
- C Which priority or deadline Ellis will change
- D The stated task durations

Answers and explanations: page 99.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

competing request / visitor list / revised deadline / task duration / coverage / overcommitment / schedule impact / decision readback / priority decision / time window

08

- 01 **Ellis:** Could you check this spreadsheet by ten twenty? It needs twenty minutes, and I'd like it ready for the next discussion.
- 02 **Rosa:** Before I accept the ¹ _____, can we look at what's already due? It's ten now, and the existing tasks fill the next hour.
- 03 **Ellis:** I knew about the room pack. What's the other deadline?
- 04 **Rosa:** The ² _____ is due at ten thirty and needs thirty minutes. The room pack also takes thirty minutes and is due at eleven.
- 05 **Ellis:** If you start the spreadsheet right away, it finishes at ten twenty. Where does that leave the list?
- 06 **Rosa:** It uses twenty minutes of the ³ _____. With the list next, its earliest finish becomes ten fifty, not ten thirty.
- 07 **Ellis:** Could you do the list faster to catch up? I'm trying to avoid moving the visitor deadline.
- 08 **Rosa:** The supplied ⁴ _____ is thirty minutes. I can't responsibly promise a shorter one without a basis for it.
- 09 **Ellis:** Then the room pack would follow the list and finish at eleven twenty. That's late as well.
- 10 **Rosa:** Yes. That's the ⁵ _____ of spreadsheet, list, then room pack. Those finish times aren't approved deadline changes yet.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ellis:** Could someone else assemble the pack while you work on the check?
- 12 **Rosa:** There's no available ⁶ _____. No colleague is free, so a handover won't solve this particular conflict.
- 13 **Ellis:** All three feel urgent, but I see that saying urgent doesn't create another twenty minutes.
- 14 **Rosa:** I need a ⁷ _____. Should the spreadsheet come first, and if so, which existing commitment may move?
- 15 **Ellis:** Let me check which deadline has flexibility before answering. I don't want you to drop the list without me realizing.
- 16 **Rosa:** Thank you. Any ⁸ _____ needs explicit agreement. Until then, the list is still due at ten thirty and the pack at eleven.
- 17 **Ellis:** Don't treat the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to choose what changes.
- 18 **Rosa:** Understood. That avoids ⁹ _____: eighty minutes of work can't fit into the available sixty while preserving these original deadlines.
- 19 **Ellis:** Keep the durations and consequences in front of us. I'll use those to make the choice.
- 20 **Rosa:** Once you decide, I'll give a ¹⁰ _____ of the agreed order and any changed deadline. For now, the priority choice is still outstanding.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. competing request | 2. visitor list | 3. time window | 4. task duration | 5. schedule impact | 6. coverage | 7. priority decision | 8. revised deadline | 9. overcommitment | 10. decision readback

Ask for a realistic priority decision

F Say it

Complete the workload readback. Keep calculated finish times separate from approved deadline changes.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

eighty / 10:30 / decision / 10:50

08

Assistant: "The three tasks require ¹ _____ minutes in total."

Manager: "The visitor list is originally due at ² _____."

Assistant: "If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than ³ _____."

Manager: "A priority ⁴ _____ is still needed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. eighty | 2. 10:30 | 3. 10:50 | 4. decision

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Complete the priority-negotiation dialogue.
2. Read the proposed sequence aloud with finish times 10:20, 10:50, and 11:20. Identify them as consequences, not approved deadlines, using Rosa's supplied wording.
3. Complete the transfer and check the key. Repeat the final request for the still-missing priority decision.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Receipts are not the reimbursement

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile an expense claim without paying company-funded or personal costs twice.

Fictional trip, all amounts in dollars. Hotel receipt \$264, already paid directly by the company. Employee paid a \$68 meal receipt: \$48 eligible business share and \$20 excluded personal share under this case's policy. Employee also paid eligible rail fare \$42 and received a \$50 cash advance. Figures include all applicable charges; no extra tax, fee, or currency conversion. Approval and payment are pending.

PEOPLE / Mira: Traveler | Ben: Administrative assistant

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

company-paid expense / itemization / net reimbursement / out-of-pocket expenses / cash advance / payment method

- 01 **Mira:** The receipts total three hundred seventy-four dollars. I took off the fifty-dollar advance and put three hundred twenty-four as the amount the company owes me.
- 02 **Ben:** We need to separate the ¹ _____ first. The two-hundred-sixty-four-dollar hotel bill was already paid directly by the company, not by you.
- 03 **Mira:** So the hotel receipt belongs with the trip record, but it isn't another two hundred sixty-four dollars to pay into my account.
- 04 **Ben:** Exactly. Keep it as a ² _____. Supporting the trip record and reimbursing you are different purposes; the receipt shouldn't disappear.
- 05 **Mira:** I paid the meal bill myself. It's sixty-eight in total, but the worksheet marks twenty as my personal share and forty-eight as eligible.
- 06 **Ben:** Use that supplied ³ _____. Forty-eight enters this claim's eligible employee-paid amount. The twenty is excluded under the fictional policy.
- 07 **Mira:** And the forty-two-dollar rail ticket is fully eligible here. That gives me ninety dollars of eligible costs I paid, before the advance.
- 08 **Ben:** Yes. Those are the ⁴ _____ relevant to this calculation: forty-eight plus forty-two. Don't add the meal's personal share back into that subtotal.
- 09 **Mira:** Now I subtract the fifty dollars I already received. That leaves forty, not three hundred twenty-four or ninety.
- 10 **Ben:** Correct. The ⁵ _____ is applied once. It's not another expense and it doesn't need to be subtracted from every receipt separately.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Mira:** Then the amount due to me is forty dollars, assuming this claim is approved. I shouldn't describe it as already paid.
- 12 **Ben:** Right. The calculated ⁶ _____ is forty. Calculation, approval, and transfer of money are three different stages.
- 13 **Mira:** I still want the approver to see why the meal receipt says sixty-eight when the eligible line says forty-eight. Will that look like a mismatch?
- 14 **Ben:** Not if the split is clear. Retain the total receipt and show forty-eight business plus twenty personal. The two parts reconcile to sixty-eight.
- 15 **Mira:** And I shouldn't enter another tax allowance because these figures already include all the applicable charges supplied in this example.
- 16 **Ben:** Exactly. No extra tax, fee, or exchange adjustment has been specified. Adding one would change the case instead of checking it.
- 17 **Mira:** What if the advance had been a hundred, with the same ninety dollars of eligible employee-paid costs? Would the company still owe me ten?
- 18 **Ben:** The direction would reverse: ten would remain to return under the case's settlement rule. An excess advance isn't another reimbursement due to you.
- 19 **Mira:** I'll submit the hotel as company-paid, retain the meal split, include the rail receipt, and show ninety less fifty equals forty due.
- 20 **Ben:** That gives the approver a traceable reconciliation. Keep the personal exclusion and advance visible, and leave approval and payment marked pending until they're actually confirmed.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. payment method | 2. company-paid expense | 3. itemization | 4. out-of-pocket expenses | 5. cash advance | 6. net reimbursement

Keep the payer and advance visible

F Say it in a new situation

Another fictional trip has \$120 of eligible employee-paid expenses, plus a separate \$15 personal expense excluded by policy. The company directly paid \$200 of additional travel costs. The employee received an \$80 advance. No other amounts apply; approval is pending.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / 80 / 40 / 120

09

Traveler: Eligible employee-paid costs are ¹ _____ dollars.

Assistant: The advance to subtract once is ² _____ dollars.

Traveler: The calculated amount due to me is ³ _____ dollars.

Assistant: The approval status is still ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 120 | 2. 80 | 3. 40 | 4. pending

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Check the people behind the rows

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Review a personalized mailing by recipient identity, selection rules, and field accuracy.

Fictional printed confirmation mailing: six rows, IDs A01, A02, A02, A03, A04, A05. The owner confirms the two A02 rows are an identical duplicate, not separate people. A01-A03 are confirmed; A04 declined; A05 is pending. Send one letter per confirmed person only. A02 and A03 share a postal address but are different people. A01's verified test postal code is 00123. Nothing has been dispatched.

PEOPLE / Elena: Office assistant | Kai: List owner

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

recipient filter / recipient identifier / merge field / duplicate record / leading zeros / data source

10

- 01 **Elena:** The sheet has six rows, so I expected six letters. But A02 appears twice, and two different names have the same postal address.
- 02 **Kai:** Start with the ¹ _____, not the row count. A02 is duplicated; those two rows belong to one person, not two attendees.
- 03 **Elena:** That leaves five distinct people. Should I also combine A02 and A03 because their address matches?
- 04 **Kai:** No. A shared address isn't a ² _____ by itself. They're different people and each needs a separate letter if included in the approved mailing.
- 05 **Elena:** The mailing is for confirmed attendees only. A01, A02, and A03 are confirmed; A04 declined and A05 hasn't answered.
- 06 **Kai:** Then the ³ _____ leaves three letters after resolving the duplicate. It doesn't leave five, six, or four with A02 counted twice.
- 07 **Elena:** I'll exclude the declined and pending records from this run. That doesn't mean deleting their records from the office's main list.
- 08 **Kai:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ still contains their statuses. We're selecting a mailing audience, not erasing people or changing their replies.
- 09 **Elena:** The preview shows A01's postal code as 123, but your verified source says 00123. Can I just ignore the missing zeros?
- 10 **Kai:** No. Those ⁵ _____ belong to the code. Preserve it as text and check the merged result against the source, rather than accepting a shortened identifier.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Elena:** Changing the cell format now wouldn't recover characters already lost from an imported number. I'll check the original source value rather than invent padding.
- 12 **Kai:** Good. Also verify the ⁶ _____ mapping. A correct greeting paired with another person's address would still produce the wrong letter.
- 13 **Elena:** I'll compare all three complete previews, not only the template. The shared address makes it particularly important to check the individual names.
- 14 **Kai:** Yes. A template can look right before actual values are inserted. Check each selected record's name, address, code, and confirmed status together.
- 15 **Elena:** The tool offers a duplicate finder based on names. Should its suggestion override your confirmed IDs?
- 16 **Kai:** No. A suggested match needs review against the record meaning. Our known duplicate is A02; matching names or addresses alone doesn't prove identical people.
- 17 **Elena:** So the check is three letters: A01, A02, A03. One A02, no A04 or A05, and no combined household letter.
- 18 **Kai:** That's the required selection. Keep the source correction traceable and confirm the final output count against those three identifiers.
- 19 **Elena:** I'll keep dispatch pending while we review the corrected previews. Generating a file hasn't put anything in the post.
- 20 **Kai:** Exactly. Record the list review and final output separately from dispatch. The result should be three accurate individual confirmations, not simply six copies because there were six rows.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. recipient identifier | 2. duplicate record | 3. recipient filter | 4. data source | 5. leading zeros | 6. merge field

Count selected people, not rows

F Say it in a new situation

A new fictional list has B01, B02, B02, B03, B04. The owner confirms identical B02 duplication. B01 and B03 are confirmed, B02 pending, B04 declined. Send one letter per confirmed person only. B01's verified test postal code is 00456; the preview currently shows 456. No dispatch has occurred.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unconfirmed / two / 00456 / pending

10

Assistant: The selected mailing should contain ¹ _____ letters.

Owner: B02 remains ² _____, not confirmed.

Assistant: B01's code must read ³ _____ in the output.

Owner: Dispatch is ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. two | 2. pending | 3. 00456 | 4. unconfirmed

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Pages, sheets, and finished copies

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Specify a booklet order without confusing page count, paper count, proofs, and approval.

Fictional print brief: 20 A4 pages including all covers, printed as folded A3 booklets. Each physical A3 sheet carries two A4 pages per side, four pages across both sides. Need 30 finished booklets plus two separate complete physical proofs. All use the same paper; no extra covers, waste allowance, or spare copies. Full production must await proof approval. Price and delivery date are not supplied.

PEOPLE / Sam: Office coordinator | Farah: Print-room lead

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

production quantity / sheet count / Duplex printing / physical proof / booklet imposition / finished size

11

- 01 **Sam:** I wrote thirty copies of twenty pages, so six hundred sheets. Then I added two sheets for the proofs. Is that the right paper count?
- 02 **Farah:** Not for this ¹ _____. Six hundred is the number of finished document pages across thirty booklets, not the number of A3 sheets.
- 03 **Sam:** Each A3 sheet has two A4 pages on the front and two on the back. That makes four document pages per physical sheet.
- 04 **Farah:** Right. ² _____ uses both sides here. Twenty pages divided by four gives five A3 sheets for each complete booklet.
- 05 **Sam:** Then thirty finished copies require a hundred fifty sheets, before the separate proofs. I shouldn't halve that again just because they're double-sided.
- 06 **Farah:** Correct. The ³ _____ already includes the two-sided layout. Dividing by two again would count the same paper saving twice.
- 07 **Sam:** The brief includes covers within the twenty pages. So I don't add another cover sheet to every copy.
- 08 **Farah:** Exactly. Also, the ⁴ _____ is A4. A3 describes the paper going into this job, not the size of each finished page.
- 09 **Sam:** What about the two proofs? I treated them as two extra pages, but you need two complete assembled booklets for review.
- 10 **Farah:** Yes. Each ⁵ _____ uses five sheets. Two proofs add ten, giving one hundred sixty sheets under this exact brief.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Sam:** That's thirty copies for distribution plus two separate proofs, not thirty copies with the proofs taken out of the delivery quantity.
- 12 **Farah:** Right. The ⁶ _____ remains thirty. We prepare the proofs first, but the full run waits for approval.
- 13 **Sam:** If I say the file is ready, that doesn't mean you have permission to print all thirty before anyone checks the folded result.
- 14 **Farah:** Correct. A ready file and an approved proof are different statuses. We need to check the assembled page order, orientation, and content before release.
- 15 **Sam:** The file is in normal reading order. Should I manually rearrange its pages to look like the outer and inner print sheets?
- 16 **Farah:** Don't assume that. Confirm the print-room input requirement. Applying booklet arrangement twice can scramble the sequence; the supplied count alone doesn't establish the correct production file.
- 17 **Sam:** And one hundred sixty is an exact-use calculation. It doesn't include test waste, damaged sheets, or an extra stock allowance.
- 18 **Farah:** Yes. Any allowance would need to be stated separately. We haven't supplied one, and we also haven't agreed a price or delivery date.
- 19 **Sam:** I'll revise the brief: twenty pages including covers, A4 finished, A3 duplex booklet layout, thirty distribution copies plus two full proofs.
- 20 **Farah:** Add five sheets per booklet and one hundred sixty for the stated quantities. Keep full production pending proof approval, with price and delivery still to confirm.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. booklet imposition | 2. Duplex printing | 3. sheet count | 4. finished size | 5. physical proof | 6. production quantity

Count another booklet order

F Say it in a new situation

A fictional 24-page booklet, covers included, uses four finished pages per physical sheet. Need 18 distribution copies plus one separate complete proof. No waste, spare copies, or extra covers. The proof has not been approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

108 / 114 / pending / six

Coordinator: Each booklet requires ¹ _____ sheets.

Print lead: The eighteen distribution copies use ² _____ sheets.

Coordinator: Including the complete proof, exact usage is ³ _____ sheets.

Print lead: Full production remains ⁴ _____ .

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. six | 2. 108 | 3. 114 | 4. pending

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.

2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.

3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is missing from the initial request?

D. Whose local time 3:00 refers to

The request supplies a clock time but does not identify the intended office reference.

2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

C. 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office

The brief explicitly gives the date-specific relationship between the two local times.

3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

A. Confirm the intended time reference

Clarifying the intended office time is necessary before sending the invitation.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which clarification is best?

C. Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?

The question directly resolves the missing location reference for the requested time.

2. Which entry preserves the clarified meeting without adding missing details?

B. One meeting: Maya's office 3:00, other office noon; duration pending

The supplied equivalence names one moment, but neither a duration nor an accepted invitation has been established.

3. What does calendar availability establish?

D. The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

Availability concerns the calendar slot rather than intention, duration, or acceptance.

4. Which detail must not be invented?

C. A one-hour meeting duration

The brief provides no duration from which a one-hour meeting could be established.

01 Conversation answers

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. time reference. Turn 2. Time reference identifies which office's clock gives the requested three o'clock its intended meaning.

2. equivalent time. Turn 4. Equivalent time is noon in the other office when Maya's office shows three.

3. local time. Turn 6. Local time refers to each office's own clock display for the same meeting moment.

4. calendar availability. Turn 8. Calendar availability confirms an open slot but does not supply the missing duration or location.

5. meeting request. Turn 10. Meeting request remains a proposal whose details must be confirmed before an invitation is issued.

6. date-specific. Turn 12. Date-specific limits the supplied equivalence to the fictional meeting date rather than every future meeting.

7. Acceptance. Turn 14. Acceptance is an attendee's agreement to an invitation, distinct from a calendar appearing open.

8. invitation. Turn 16. Invitation is the attendance request that should contain confirmed scheduling details without assuming prior acceptance.

9. schedule readback. Turn 18. Schedule readback repeats both equivalent office times and preserves that invitations have not yet been sent.

10. Recurrence. Turn 20. Recurrence describes a repeating schedule, which Maya has not authorized in the current request.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. time

Assistant: "Whose local time do you mean?"

Time is the ambiguous reference that must be attached to an office.

2. noon

Colleague: "Three in my office equals noon at the other office."

Noon is the supplied equivalent for the fictional meeting date.

3. open

Assistant: "Both calendars are open at that time."

Open describes availability without establishing that an invitation has been accepted.

4. sending

Colleague: "Confirm the remaining details before sending."

Sending must follow clarification rather than precede the missing details.



02 Briefing and language checks

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which team does Lena need?

A. Facilities

The call concerns delivery D18 and is explicitly for facilities.

2. What is the facilities extension?

D. 214

The supplied internal telephone extension for facilities is 214.

3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

D. A requested callback deadline

Lena requests the callback, but the team's availability is unknown.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which message is accurate?

D. Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

The correct message preserves the caller, team, reference, and requested timing.

2. Which response overpromises?

B. They will definitely call before four

The team's unknown availability cannot support a definite callback promise.

3. Which information still needs verification before the message is usable?

A. The actual contact details for Lena's chosen reply route

A telephone preference alone does not supply a verified callback number; the delivery purpose and facilities route are already established.

4. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

C. Extension 214

The brief supplies 214 specifically as the facilities telephone extension.

02 Conversation answers

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. purpose of call.** Turn 2. Purpose of call distinguishes the delivery inquiry from an invoice matter before Dev routes it.
- 2. delivery reference.** Turn 4. Delivery reference is D18 and should not be relabeled as an invoice identifier.
- 3. callback request.** Turn 6. Callback request records Lena's wish for a return call without promising the team's response time.
- 4. requested deadline.** Turn 8. Requested deadline preserves before four as Lena's timing request, distinct from an accepted commitment.
- 5. preferred contact route.** Turn 10. Preferred contact route is a telephone call, as Lena chooses during the exchange.
- 6. caller identity.** Turn 12. Caller identity is Lena Park, keeping this message distinct from other callers and deliveries.
- 7. extension.** Turn 14. Extension identifies the internal telephone number 214, which Dev corrects without changing the delivery reference.
- 8. message readback.** Turn 16. Message readback combines the caller, intended team, delivery reference, route, and requested deadline for confirmation.
- 9. handoff note.** Turn 18. Handoff note must preserve a facilities delivery inquiry rather than inventing a finance approval request.
- 10. response commitment.** Turn 20. Response commitment would require confirmation from the relevant team, which Dev does not currently have.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. facilities

Assistant: "Lena needs the facilities team."

Facilities handles the stated inquiry, not finance or payroll.

2. D18

Caller: "The delivery reference is D18."

D18 identifies the delivery discussed in this telephone message.

3. 214

Assistant: "The team extension is 214."

214 is the supplied facilities extension, not the delivery identifier.

4. deadline

Caller: "Before 4:00 is my requested deadline."

Deadline preserves the requested timing without asserting that the team has accepted it.

03 Briefing and language checks

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

C. Printer replacement

Farah prioritizes the printer item during the final ten minutes.

2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

C. Two quotations

The supplied action is to obtain two quotes by Thursday.

3. What is the status of signage?

D. To be deferred to the next meeting

Deferral moves the item to a later meeting without resolving its substance.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which action record is correct?

A. Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved

The record names the owner, deliverable, deadline, and purchase-approval limit.

2. What does deferred mean here?

B. Moved to the next meeting

Deferral postpones discussion without deciding or deleting the item.

3. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

C. Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?

The question verifies the bounded task that Sam can actually carry out.

4. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

C. A printer order is authorized

The brief explicitly states that no purchase has been approved.

03 Conversation answers

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. priority item.** Turn 2. Priority item is printer replacement, which Farah selects for the remaining meeting time.
- 2. deliverable.** Turn 4. Deliverable is two supplier quotes, not a selected or purchased printer.
- 3. action owner.** Turn 6. Action owner is Sam, who has offered to obtain the two quotations.
- 4. due date.** Turn 8. Due date is Thursday, the stated deadline for the two-quote deliverable.
- 5. purchase approval.** Turn 10. Purchase approval has not been given, so obtaining quotations must not be recorded as permission to buy.
- 6. deferred item.** Turn 12. Deferred item keeps visitor signage for the next meeting without treating it as rejected or completed.
- 7. minutes.** Turn 14. Minutes should preserve both the confirmed quote action and the unresolved signage item.
- 8. action readback.** Turn 16. Action readback confirms Sam, two quotations, Thursday, and the absence of purchase approval together.
- 9. open item.** Turn 18. Open item identifies signage as unresolved despite its move to the next meeting.
- 10. decision log.** Turn 20. Decision log records what was actually agreed, including the boundary between preparation and spending authority.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. Sam

Chair: "The action owner is Sam."

Sam is the assistant who offered and accepted the quote-gathering task.

2. quotations

Assistant: "I will obtain two quotations."

Quotations are the deliverable, not an approved printer purchase.

3. Thursday

Chair: "The due date is Thursday."

Thursday is the explicitly agreed deadline for obtaining the quotes.

4. deferred

Assistant: "Visitor signage is deferred to the next meeting."

Deferred postpones discussion without rejecting, approving, or completing the signage item.

04 Briefing and language checks

Checking document versions and access

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which version is current?

D. Version 3, approved this morning

Version 3 is the approved current guide, despite the earlier email.

2. What is wrong in version 2?

B. The reception floor

The brief identifies the reception-floor information as the outdated error.

3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

D. The document owner through the appropriate process

The request belongs with the document owner, not an unauthorized expansion of permissions.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which correction is accurate?

D. Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

The correction identifies the actual current version and the known error.

2. What permission does Kai need here?

C. Viewing access

The stated problem concerns opening the guide, not editing or unrestricted sharing.

3. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

A. Making the folder public

Independently widening permissions is explicitly outside the supplied task.

4. What should Elena avoid claiming?

C. Kai's access is fixed before confirmation

A request for access does not prove that access has been granted or tested.

04 Conversation answers

Checking document versions and access

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. approved version.** Turn 2. Approved version is version 3, accepted this morning and replacing the outdated guide Elena sent.
- 2. current guide.** Turn 4. Current guide is the authoritative version 3, which should supply the floor rather than Elena guessing.
- 3. viewing access.** Turn 6. Viewing access is the permission Kai needs to open the approved guide without requesting editing authority.
- 4. permission scope.** Turn 8. Permission scope defines who can access the file, and Elena must not expand it independently.
- 5. access request.** Turn 10. Access request should ask for Kai's viewing permission, not unnecessary editing or public-sharing rights.
- 6. superseded.** Turn 12. Superseded means version 2 has been replaced and should not remain the active source of visitor directions.
- 7. correction notice.** Turn 14. Correction notice explicitly identifies the outdated message and directs recipients to the approved replacement.
- 8. access error.** Turn 16. Access error remains unresolved until the appropriate permission is established and access is confirmed.
- 9. replacement message.** Turn 18. Replacement message corrects the earlier communication while the separate viewing-access request remains visible.
- 10. document owner.** Turn 20. Document owner is the appropriate contact for resolving the requested viewing permission without unauthorized sharing.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 3

Assistant: "The approved guide is version 3."

Version 3 was approved this morning and supersedes the earlier attachment.

2. floor

Recipient: "The older version has the wrong reception floor."

Floor is the specific outdated detail identified in the brief.

3. viewing

Assistant: "You need viewing access to the current guide."

Viewing allows the required reading without assuming editing or public-sharing rights.

4. owner

Recipient: "Please ask the document owner to resolve it."

Owner is the appropriate role for the access request under the supplied instructions.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A. Twelve

Purchase order P44 explicitly requests twelve archive boxes.

2. What quantity was physically checked?

B. Ten boxes

Omar checked the shipment and found ten rather than the twelve listed.

3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A. Nothing is confirmed

No second package or backorder is documented in the supplied facts.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

D. P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

The correct statement keeps the order, delivery document, and physical count distinct.

2. What is the outstanding difference?

B. Two boxes

Twelve ordered minus ten counted leaves two boxes unaccounted for.

3. Which question is justified?

C. Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?

The question seeks missing supply information without inventing a cause or status.

4. Which record should remain accurate?

D. The checked receipt of ten

The receipt record must preserve the actual checked quantity despite the document discrepancy.

05 Conversation answers

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. ordered quantity. Turn 2. Ordered quantity is twelve archive boxes, the amount specified on purchase order P44.

2. quantity discrepancy. Turn 4. Quantity discrepancy is the difference between twelve ordered and documented and ten physically checked.

3. split shipment. Turn 6. Split shipment would mean more than one consignment, but no such arrangement is documented here.

4. outstanding quantity. Turn 8. Outstanding quantity is the two ordered boxes not yet accounted for in the checked receipt.

5. order reference. Turn 10. Order reference P44 links the archive-box discrepancy to the correct supply transaction.

6. checked count. Turn 12. Checked count is ten, and it must not be changed merely to match the delivery paperwork.

7. supplier query. Turn 14. Supplier query requests clarification of the missing supply facts without accusing anyone of wrongdoing.

8. dispatch record. Turn 16. Dispatch record may clarify what was sent, but its contents have not yet been confirmed in the conversation.

9. Payment approval. Turn 18. Payment approval is separate from the supply query and has not been given by Omar.

10. supplier response. Turn 20. Supplier response should address both the outstanding two boxes and the unconfirmed further-shipment position.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. P44

Assistant: "The purchase order is P44."

P44 identifies the archive-box order being queried with the supplier.

2. twelve

Supplier: "The order and delivery note both list twelve boxes."

Twelve is the documented ordered quantity and delivery-note quantity.

3. ten

Assistant: "The checked shipment contains ten boxes."

Ten is the actual checked receipt and must remain distinct from the paperwork.

4. two

Supplier: "The outstanding difference is two boxes."

Two is the difference between twelve ordered and ten physically checked.

06 Briefing and language checks

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

C. Jordan Chen in facilities

The visitor reference explicitly identifies Jordan Chen in facilities.

2. Where should Taylor wait?

C. At reception

Taylor has not been cleared to enter other areas alone.

3. What is not confirmed?

C. When the host will reach reception

No host arrival time is provided in the supplied information.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which host message is accurate?

D. Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

The message retains the visitor, reference, host, time, and current waiting location.

2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

B. Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen

The instruction states the supplied waiting arrangement without inventing timing or access.

3. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

A. V12 and the full host name

The appointment reference identifies the specific Jordan intended for this visit.

4. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

C. Permission to enter other areas alone

A meeting arrangement does not itself establish the supplied unaccompanied-access permission.

06 Conversation answers

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. visitor reference.** Turn 2. Visitor reference V12 identifies the intended arrangement and resolves which Jordan is the host.
- 2. appointment record.** Turn 4. Appointment record for V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities for the scheduled ten o'clock meeting.
- 3. host notification.** Turn 6. Host notification tells Jordan Chen that Taylor has arrived and is waiting at reception.
- 4. host availability.** Turn 8. Host availability is not established merely because the appointment is scheduled for ten.
- 5. waiting area.** Turn 10. Waiting area is reception, where Taylor should remain pending the next arrangement.
- 6. unaccompanied access.** Turn 12. Unaccompanied access is separate from the meeting reference and has not been granted to Taylor.
- 7. arrival.** Turn 14. Arrival is the fact that Taylor is presently at reception, not merely a future appointment inquiry.
- 8. reception wait.** Turn 16. Reception wait is the agreed current arrangement, without inventing another room or host arrival estimate.
- 9. surname.** Turn 18. Surname Chen distinguishes the intended host from Jordan Patel in sales.
- 10. visitor handoff.** Turn 20. Visitor handoff concerns the next confirmed reception arrangement rather than an assumed right to enter alone.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. V12

Receptionist: "The visitor reference is V12."

V12 identifies Taylor's meeting arrangement with the intended host.

2. Chen

Visitor: "I am meeting Jordan Chen."

Chen distinguishes the facilities host from Jordan Patel in sales.

3. facilities

Receptionist: "Your host works in facilities."

Facilities is the department associated with Jordan Chen in the supplied record.

4. reception

Visitor: "I will wait at reception."

Reception is the stated waiting location until the next arrangement is confirmed.

06

07 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying travel options and booking status

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A. \$20

Option B costs \$90 and option A costs \$70, so the difference is \$20.

2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

C. \$80

The \$90 fare less the stated \$10 deduction leaves an \$80 refund before departure.

3. What must happen before purchase?

A. Obtain the required purchasing approval

Purchasing approval is explicitly still required before the assistant can book.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which comparison is complete?

D. A is \$70 nonrefundable; B is \$90 with an \$80 refund before departure

The comparison retains both prices and B's conditional refund after the deduction.

2. What does the \$10 represent?

B. The deduction from B's refund

The supplied \$10 is subtracted from B's \$90 refund, not from the price comparison.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. B is refundable after departure without restrictions

The supplied terms establish a before-departure refund only, with no later rule provided.

4. Which handoff is ready for the approver?

B. Both quotes with conditions, meeting unconfirmed, no purchase approved

A comparison can be passed for decision without selecting a fare, issuing a ticket, or extending the supplied refund terms.

07 Conversation answers

Clarifying travel options and booking status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. fare. Turn 2. Fare is the upfront travel price: seventy dollars for A and ninety dollars for B.

2. nonrefundable. Turn 4. Nonrefundable describes option A under the supplied quoted terms without inventing additional exceptions.

3. net refund. Turn 6. Net refund is eighty dollars after subtracting the stated ten-dollar deduction from B's ninety-dollar fare.

4. upfront cost. Turn 8. Upfront cost is the purchase price, separate from the amount retained if a conditional refund occurs.

5. price difference. Turn 10. Price difference is twenty dollars because the quoted fares are ninety and seventy dollars.

6. before departure. Turn 12. Before departure is the stated refund condition, and no after-departure permission is supplied.

7. booking status. Turn 14. Booking status remains unapproved because a comparison and questions do not authorize a purchase.

8. conditional comparison. Turn 16. Conditional comparison presents the two prices and B's limited refund without choosing or booking for Mira.

9. unconfirmed meeting. Turn 18. Unconfirmed meeting describes the unresolved travel purpose without converting it into a recommendation or cancellation.

10. Purchasing approval. Turn 20. Purchasing approval is the missing authorization required before Ben can turn the comparison into a booking.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. seventy

Assistant: "Option A costs seventy dollars."

Seventy is the nonrefundable option's stated upfront price.

2. ninety

Traveler: "Option B costs ninety dollars."

Ninety is B's purchase price before any later conditional refund.

3. eighty

Assistant: "Before departure, B permits an eighty-dollar refund."

Eighty is ninety minus the stated ten-dollar refund deduction.

4. approval

Traveler: "Purchasing approval is still required."

Approval remains necessary because discussing the alternatives does not authorize a ticket purchase.

08 Briefing and language checks

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is due at 10:30?

A. The visitor list

The visitor list has the earliest of the two original deadlines.

2. How much work is requested in total?

D. Eighty minutes

Two thirty-minute tasks plus a twenty-minute check total eighty minutes.

3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

B. Choose priorities or adjust a deadline

The supplied capacity conflict requires a decision about priorities or timing.

D Language checks / page 72

1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

B. 10:50

Twenty minutes for the check plus thirty for the list gives a 10:50 finish.

2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

A. 11:20

The check and two thirty-minute tasks require eighty minutes from 10:00.

3. Which response is professionally clear?

A. I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes

The response states the capacity conflict and asks the manager for an explicit decision.

4. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

C. Which priority or deadline Ellis will change

The case supplies the conflict but does not provide Ellis's final priority decision.

08 Conversation answers

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. competing request. Turn 2. Competing request is the new twenty-minute spreadsheet check that conflicts with Rosa's existing commitments.

2. visitor list. Turn 4. Visitor list is due at 10:30 and requires thirty minutes, so it occupies the first available half hour.

3. time window. Turn 6. Time window from 10:00 to 11:00 contains sixty minutes, less than the eighty minutes of requested work.

4. task duration. Turn 8. Task duration is thirty minutes for each existing task and cannot be silently reduced to make the schedule fit.

5. schedule impact. Turn 10. Schedule impact is a 10:50 list finish followed by an 11:20 room-pack finish if the spreadsheet goes first.

6. coverage. Turn 12. Coverage would require another available person, which the supplied situation explicitly lacks.

7. priority decision. Turn 14. Priority decision determines which task takes precedence and which existing commitment must change.

8. revised deadline. Turn 16. Revised deadline must be explicitly agreed rather than inferred from Rosa's explanation of the conflict.

9. overcommitment. Turn 18. Overcommitment would be promising all three original deadlines despite eighty minutes of work in the available hour.

10. decision readback. Turn 20. Decision readback follows an actual priority decision; no revised sequence or deadline is approved yet.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. eighty

Assistant: "The three tasks require eighty minutes in total."

Eighty combines the two thirty-minute tasks and the new twenty-minute check.

2. 10:30

Manager: "The visitor list is originally due at 10:30."

10:30 remains the original deadline until a change is explicitly agreed.

3. 10:50

Assistant: "If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than 10:50."

10:50 follows twenty minutes for the check and thirty for the visitor list.

4. decision

Manager: "A priority decision is still needed."

Decision remains outstanding because no changed priority or deadline has been approved.

08

09 Conversation answers

Receipts are not the reimbursement

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. payment method. Turn 2. The hotel was paid directly by the company, while the meal and rail fare were employee-paid; adding all receipts does not give the amount owed to Mira.

2. company-paid expense. Turn 4. The hotel remains a documented trip cost but is excluded from employee reimbursement because the company has already paid it directly.

3. itemization. Turn 6. Itemization separates the meal receipt's forty-eight-dollar eligible share from its twenty-dollar personal share; the whole sixty-eight is not reimbursable in this case.

4. out-of-pocket expenses. Turn 8. The eligible employee-paid amounts are forty-eight for the meal and forty-two for rail, totaling ninety; the company-paid hotel is not added.

5. cash advance. Turn 10. The fifty-dollar advance is money already provided for the trip; subtract it once from ninety dollars of eligible employee-paid costs to obtain forty due.

6. net reimbursement. Turn 12. Ninety eligible employee-paid dollars less the fifty-dollar advance leaves forty dollars due to the employee, subject to the pending approval and payment.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 120

Traveler: Eligible employee-paid costs are 120 dollars.

The case explicitly supplies one hundred twenty as eligible; the separate personal and company-paid amounts are not added.

2. 80

Assistant: The advance to subtract once is 80 dollars.

Eighty has already been provided to the employee and offsets the eligible employee-paid total.

3. 40

Traveler: The calculated amount due to me is 40 dollars.

One hundred twenty minus eighty equals forty; the personal fifteen and company-paid two hundred do not enter this reimbursement.

4. pending

Assistant: The approval status is still pending .

Reconciling the amounts does not establish approval or payment of the claim.

Background reading: [Microsoft Learn: settling expense reports against cash advances](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Check the people behind the rows

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. recipient identifier. Turn 2. The supplied IDs distinguish people; the owner confirms that the repeated A02 row is an identical duplicate, leaving five distinct people in six rows.

2. duplicate record. Turn 4. A02 and A03 are different people sharing an address; only the repeated A02 row is confirmed as an identical duplicate in this case.

3. recipient filter. Turn 6. The confirmed-only selection includes A01, A02, and A03 once each; declined A04 and pending A05 are excluded from this particular mailing.

4. data source. Turn 8. The underlying contact data remains distinct from the subset selected for this mailing; excluding someone from the current run does not require deleting their source record.

5. leading zeros. Turn 10. The verified test code is 00123; dropping its leading zeros changes the identifier, and the prepared text value must retain all five characters.

6. merge field. Turn 12. A merge field inserts a particular source value into the template; the name, address, and code must all come from the intended recipient's record.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. two

Assistant: The selected mailing should contain two letters.

Only confirmed B01 and B03 qualify; the duplicate pending B02 does not add an eligible recipient.

2. pending

Owner: B02 remains pending, not confirmed.

Its supplied response status stays pending even though the duplicate row must be resolved.

3. 00456

Assistant: B01's code must read 00456 in the output.

The verified source contains both leading zeros; the preview's 456 has lost part of the identifier.

4. unconfirmed

Owner: Dispatch is unconfirmed .

A selected list and corrected preview do not establish that letters have been dispatched.

10

Background reading: [Microsoft Support: preparing source fields and postal codes for mail merge](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Pages, sheets, and finished copies

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. booklet imposition. Turn 2. Booklet imposition arranges the document pages for folding; this brief puts four finished pages on each physical A3 sheet, not one page per sheet.

2. Duplex printing. Turn 4. Duplex means both sides are printed; the supplied two-pages-per-side layout gives four document pages across a physical sheet, not eight.

3. sheet count. Turn 6. Thirty finished booklets at five physical sheets each require one hundred fifty A3 sheets; duplex use is already included in the four-pages-per-sheet calculation.

4. finished size. Turn 8. The booklet's finished page size is A4 after the A3 sheets are folded; A3 is the input sheet size, not the finished booklet-page size.

5. physical proof. Turn 10. A complete physical proof uses all five sheets of the twenty-page booklet; two separate proofs therefore need ten sheets, not two.

6. production quantity. Turn 12. The order requires thirty finished distribution copies in addition to two proofs; the proofs must not reduce the thirty-copy delivery quantity.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. six

Coordinator: Each booklet requires six sheets.

Twenty-four finished pages divided by four pages per sheet gives six physical sheets.

2. 108

Print lead: The eighteen distribution copies use 108 sheets.

Eighteen multiplied by six equals one hundred eight sheets, before the separate proof.

3. 114

Coordinator: Including the complete proof, exact usage is 114 sheets.

The six-sheet proof is additional to the one hundred eight sheets for distribution, totaling one hundred fourteen.

4. pending

Print lead: Full production remains pending .

The brief requires proof approval, which has not occurred; a paper calculation does not release production.

11

Background reading: [Adobe: booklet arrangement, duplex sheets, and finished page order](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Clarify the reference: Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?

State availability: Both calendars are open at that equivalent time.

Read back the other clock: That will be noon in the other office.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Clarify the purpose: Is this about the delivery or an invoice?

Read back the identifier: That is D18, D followed by eighteen.

Verify the details: May I check the contact details for that route?

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Signal the time: We have ten minutes left.

Confirm the priority: We will use the remaining time for the printer item.

Keep approval separate: No purchase has been approved.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Checking document versions and access

Own the error: I sent version 2 in my earlier message.

Direct recipients clearly: Please use version 3 in the shared folder.

Name the needed permission: You need viewing access to the approved guide.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Identify the order: I am calling about purchase order P44.

State the checked count: We checked the shipment and counted ten.

Check for another shipment: Is a further shipment planned?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Open warmly: Good morning. Who are you here to see?

Ask for the reference: May I check your visitor reference?

State the next action: I will contact your host.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Clarifying travel options and booking status

Define the comparison: Both quotes cover the same trip.

Include the condition: B permits a refund before departure.

Avoid a full-refund claim: Refundable does not mean the full \$90 comes back.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Acknowledge the request: I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20.

State the second deadline: The room pack is due at 11:00.

State the immediate consequence: If I do the check first, the visitor list cannot finish before 10:50.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance confirm acceptance	6
access clearance verify access clearance	51
access error report an access error	33
access request submit an access request	32
action owner name the action owner	23
action point confirm the action point	23
action readback give an action readback	24
agenda work through the agenda	23
agenda item prioritize an agenda item	23
appointment ambiguity resolve appointment ambiguity	51
appointment record check the appointment record	50
approval date verify the approval date	33
approved version use the approved version	32
archive box order archive boxes	41
arrival acknowledge the arrival	50
arrival estimate qualify an arrival estimate	51
attachment replace the outdated attachment	32
attendee confirm the attendee list	5
backorder verify a documented backorder	41
before departure preserve the before-departure condition	59
booking status clarify booking status	59
booklet imposition confirm booklet imposition	23
budget authority confirm budget authority	24
calendar availability check calendar availability	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

calendar entry	check the calendar entry	6
call log	update the call log	15
call routing	confirm call routing	14
callback request	relay a callback request	14
caller identity	verify caller identity	14
cancellation	distinguish cancellation from comparison	60
capacity	state the capacity limit	68
carry forward	carry forward visitor signage	24
cash advance	reconcile the cash advance	60
chair	ask the chair to confirm	23
check-in	complete the check-in	50
checked count	report the checked count	41
commitment	make a realistic commitment	69
competing request	identify the competing request	68
conditional comparison	give a conditional comparison	60
consensus	verify consensus	24
contact details	verify contact details	14
Coordinated Universal Time	identify Coordinated Universal Time	6
correction notice	send a correction notice	33
coverage	confirm coverage	69
current guide	link to the current guide	32
date-specific	use a date-specific conversion	5
daylight saving time	check daylight saving time	5
deadline	clarify the deadline	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

decision log	update the decision log	24
decision readback	prepare a decision readback	69
deduction	explain the deduction	59
deferred item	retain the deferred item	24
delegation	avoid unsupported delegation	69
deliverable	define the deliverable	23
delivery note	compare the delivery note	41
delivery reconciliation	complete delivery reconciliation	42
delivery reference	capture the delivery reference	14
department	identify the correct department	15
dispatch record	check the dispatch record	42
displaced task	identify the displaced task	69
distribution list	check the distribution list	33
document link	share the current document link	33
document owner	contact the document owner	32
document version	check the document version	32
due date	record the due date	23
duplex printing	specify duplex printing	24
duration	request the meeting duration	6
earliest finish	calculate the earliest finish	69
editing permission	distinguish editing permission	32
equivalent time	read back the equivalent time	5
escort	confirm the escort arrangement	51
existing obligation	preserve existing obligations	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

expense itemization check expense itemization	60
extension confirm the extension	14
facilities identify the facilities host	50
facilities team contact the facilities team	14
fare state the fare	59
fare condition explain the fare condition	60
finance team distinguish the finance team	14
free slot identify a free slot	6
fulfillment distinguish partial fulfillment	42
handoff note prepare an accurate handoff note	15
handover coverage verify handover coverage	69
host contact the host	50
host availability check host availability	51
host notification send the host notification	50
identity match verify the identity match	51
invitation send the invitation	5
itinerary check the itinerary	60
local time confirm local time	5
location field complete the location field	6
mail merge preview the mail merge	32
meeting request clarify the meeting request	5
merge field verify the merge field	33
message readback give a message readback	15
message slip complete the message slip	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

minutes correct the minutes	24
misdirected call prevent a misdirected call	15
motion distinguish a motion from discussion	24
net refund calculate the net refund	60
nonrefundable identify a nonrefundable fare	59
noon specify noon	5
offset verify the relevant offset	6
open item preserve an open item	24
order reference include the order reference	42
ordered quantity verify the ordered quantity	41
organizer identify the organizer	5
outstanding quantity confirm the outstanding quantity	41
overcommitment avoid overcommitment	69
packing list compare the packing list	42
partial receipt record a partial receipt	42
payment approval keep payment approval separate	42
permission scope preserve permission scope	32
preferred contact route confirm the preferred contact route	14
price difference state the price difference	59
priority decision request a priority decision	68
priority item identify the priority item	23
procurement distinguish procurement stages	24
purchase approval distinguish purchase approval	23
purchase order quote the purchase order	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

purchasing approval obtain purchasing approval	59
purpose of call clarify the purpose of call	14
quantity discrepancy report a quantity discrepancy	41
quotation obtain two quotations	23
quote gathering assign quote gathering	23
quoted terms preserve the quoted terms	59
rail quote compare rail quotes	59
read-only request read-only access	33
receipt record preserve the receipt record	42
reception wait at reception	50
reception wait explain the reception wait	51
recipient availability check recipient availability	15
recipient confirmation obtain recipient confirmation	15
recurrence confirm recurrence separately	6
reference correction record a reference correction	15
refund amount calculate the refund amount	59
refund eligibility check refund eligibility	60
refundable qualify refundable	59
replacement message issue a replacement message	33
reprioritization request reprioritization	69
requested deadline preserve the requested deadline	14
reservation verify a reservation	60
response commitment distinguish a response commitment	15
restricted area identify a restricted area	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

revised deadline obtain a revised deadline	69
revision control maintain revision control	33
room pack assemble the room pack	68
sales distinguish the sales colleague	50
schedule impact explain the schedule impact	69
schedule readback give a schedule readback	6
scheduled time confirm the scheduled time	50
scheduling conflict resolve a scheduling conflict	6
second package verify a second package	41
sequence agree the task sequence	68
shared folder locate the shared folder	32
shipment plan request the shipment plan	41
short delivery query a short delivery	41
source location identify the source location	33
split shipment confirm a split shipment	41
spreadsheet check perform the spreadsheet check	68
superseded mark the guide as superseded	32
supplier comparison prepare a supplier comparison	24
supplier query raise a supplier query	42
supplier response request a supplier response	42
surname confirm the surname	50
task duration specify task duration	68
tentative hold distinguish a tentative hold	6
ticket issuance distinguish ticket issuance	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

time display compare the time displays	6
time reference clarify the time reference	5
time window define the available time window	68
time zone identify the time zone	5
trade-off explain the trade-off	68
transfer distinguish a transfer from a callback	15
travel authorization distinguish travel authorization	60
unaccompanied access distinguish unaccompanied access	51
unconfirmed meeting identify the unconfirmed meeting	60
unit count confirm the unit count	42
unrestricted link avoid an unrestricted link	33
unverified explanation avoid an unverified explanation	42
upfront cost compare upfront costs	59
urgency explain the urgency	15
version history consult version history	33
viewing access request viewing access	32
visitor badge follow the visitor-badge procedure	51
visitor handoff coordinate the visitor handoff	51
visitor list prepare the visitor list	68
visitor log update the visitor log	51
visitor reference check the visitor reference	50
voicemail identify the voicemail option	15
waiting area explain the waiting area	50
workload explain the workload	68

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Secretaries and Administrative Assistants.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for scheduling, documents, calls, records, and administrative coordination. The teaching cases are original and fictional. Checked 10 October 2026.

[2] Google Calendar Help. Use Google Calendar in Different Time Zones.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for distinguishing a meeting instant from local clock displays. The fictional case supplies its own date-specific equivalence. Checked 10 October 2026.

[3] Microsoft Support. Sharing Files, Folders, and List Items.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology for document links, viewing access, and permissions. The book does not instruct learners to change workplace access rights. Checked 10 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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